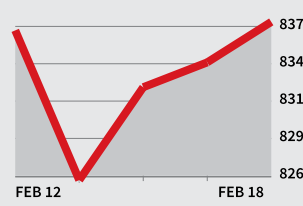


the hindu businessline

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IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	25819.35	+93.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	22.99	+0.08
US Dollar (in ₹)	90.66	-0.01
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	150977.00	-280
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	236798.00	+3843

DIGITAL GROWTH PLAY.

Bandhan Bank is working on AI for hyper-personalised loans and a super app, says ED & COO Ratan Kumar Kesh **p9**



TECHNOPHILE.

Lenovo Idea Tab Plus: The sleek tablet delivers value with features and quality **p8**

QUICKLY.

VRROOMING AHEAD

French auto tech firm Valeo to pump in €200 m



New Delhi: French auto technology provider Valeo said it plans to invest more than €200 million in two years to expand its industrial footprint in India. The investment will enable Valeo to triple its sales in India to around €700 million by 2028 and will also help prepare for the next step of high growth beyond 2028, said CEO Christophe Périllat. **p5**

PRICED OUT

MSP hike clouds India's wheat export plans

New Delhi: India will find it tough to get buyers abroad for its wheat as the domestic cost of the foodgrain is higher than the global price. The task will be tough, particularly with the government raising the MSP to ₹2,585 a quintal. Currently, wheat delivered at Kandla is priced at \$285-288 a tonne. If a freight rate of \$20 a tonne is taken into account for the Middle East and South-East Asia, the cost and freight could be \$305-308 — \$45 higher than global prices. **p12**

Sarvam AI unveils two home-grown large AI models

CLASS LEADERS. 30B model powers real-time conversations, 105B handles complex reasoning

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Sarvam AI on Tuesday unveiled two new large language models (LLMs) at the India AI Summit — a 30-billion- and a 105-billion-parameter model — both outperforming comparable models in their respective size categories on key benchmarks. In April 2025, the Union government selected Sarvam under the IndiaAI Mission to build the country's first sovereign LLM, alongside 11 other start-ups advancing the domestic AI ecosystem.

PRODUCTION-READY

The 30B-parameter model is pre-trained on 16 trillion tokens and supports a 32,000-token context length, enabling long conversations and agentic workflows while keeping inference costs low due to fewer activated parameters. Speaking at the Summit, Sarvam Co-Founder Pratyush Kumar said: "The larger the model, more the parameters. While the model is more capable, it is also harder to train and longer to



Sarvam 105B was trained from scratch, is one-sixth the size, and yet provides intelligence competitive to the earlier version of DeepSeek

PRATYUSH KUMAR
Co-founder, Sarvam



run in production. However, a 30-billion parameter model today is relatively small. Ours is a mixture-of-experts (MoE) model and has just 1 billion activated parameters, meaning that in generating every output token, it only activates 1B parameters."

Sarvam 30B is positioned as a real-time conversational engine for production use, supporting Indian languages and user-facing dialogue. It either surpasses or remains competitive with models such as OpenAI's GPT-OSS-20B, Alibaba Cloud's Qwen3-30B, Mistral AI's Mistral-3-2-24B and Google's Gemma 27B across benchmarks including Math500, HumanEval,

MBPP, Live Code Bench v6, MMLU and MMLU Pro.

ADVANCED REASONING

Sarvam 105B, the company's larger MoE model with 9 billion active parameters and a 128,000-token context window, is built for complex reasoning.

It performs strongly across mathematics, coding and Indian languages, and supports bug fixes and code generation. On benchmarks, it performs on a par with GPT-OSS-120B, Qwen3-Next-80B and Zhipu AI's GLM-4.5-Air across GPQA Diamond, Beyond AIME and MMLU Pro.

Kumar said Sarvam 105B handles Indian languages

better than larger and more expensive models such as Gemini 2.5 Flash and outperforms DeepSeek-R1, a 600B-parameter model released last year.

"While these models can evolve fast, Sarvam 105B was trained from scratch, is one-sixth the size, and yet provides intelligence competitive to the earlier version of DeepSeek," he said.

INDIA-FOCUSED EDGE

Srinivas Padmanabhuni, CTO of AiEnsured, said, "In the context of Indian language-based chatbots, whether for customer service or queries related to government services, these can be delivered to bottom-of-the-pyramid users in local Indian languages. Similarly, AI can democratise legal reasoning and research, making them accessible to the bottom-of-the-pyramid and regional language audience."

All three models, including a 3B variant, were trained using compute allocated under the IndiaAI Mission, with infrastructure support from Yotta and Nvidia.

More reports p2, p3, p4

Yotta, Nvidia team up for \$2-billion AI supercluster

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Yotta Data Services and Nvidia will partner to form one of Asia's largest AI superclusters, deploying 20,736 liquid-cooled Blackwell Ultra GPUs by August, with an investment exceeding \$2 billion, a statement said.

Yotta currently operates over 10,000 Nvidia GPUs live in production, with another 8,000 set to go live within the next quarter.

Details p3

L&T, Nvidia forge AI infra pact

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Larsen & Toubro on Wednesday partnered with Nvidia at the India AI Summit in Mumbai to build gigawatt-scale AI factory infrastructure under the IndiaAI Mission. Immediately, Nvidia GPU cluster deployment at L&T's Chennai data centre will be stepped up to 30 MW, and at a 40 MW data centre coming up in Mumbai.

Read more p3

Google rolls out India-US subsea cable initiative to boost AI connectivity

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



Google CEO Sundar Pichai at the Google AI event in New Delhi on Wednesday **PTI**

Google and Alphabet Inc Chief Executive Officer Sundar Pichai on Wednesday unveiled an 'India-America Connect Initiative', outlining plans to deploy subsea cables to strengthen artificial intelligence connectivity between the two countries and multiple locations across the Global South.

Announcing the initiative, Pichai said the project builds on the company's previously announced investments.

"Last year, we announced a \$15 billion AI hub in Vizag. This hub will house 1 GW scale compute and a new international subsea cable gateway. When finished, it'll bring jobs and benefits of cutting-edge AI to people in businesses across India. Building on this, today we are announcing the India-America Connect Initiative, which will deliver new subsea cable routes to increase AI connectivity between the US, India and multiple locations across the Southern Hemisphere," Pichai said.

The subsea cable routes will bolster high-capacity data flows critical for AI workloads, cloud services

and cross-border digital trade, positioning India as a key node in global AI infrastructure.

SKILLING PROGRAMME

To leverage the expanded digital backbone, the company said it will scale up skilling and workforce development efforts. "This includes a new Google AI professional certificate programme to help people master AI in their work. In India, we are partnering with Wadhvani AI to reach early career professionals," he noted.

Pichai also announced a tie-up with Karmayogi Bharat to train 20 million public servants across 800 districts in 18 Indian languages, and said Google will bring GenAI support to 10,000+ Atal Tinkering Labs, serving 11 million students.



Seamaster
PLANET OCEAN

For Glen Powell, the ocean is calling. Inspired by a sense of endless possibility, the charismatic actor has taken his career in almost every direction, with roles in action, drama, and romance. On his wrist, the redesigned Planet Ocean echoes that same spirit. A Co-Axial Master Chronometer collection that embodies the sea and the infinite desire to always push further.

Ω
OMEGA

QUICKLY.
PM to inaugurate India AI Impact Summit today

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the India AI Impact Summit 2026 on Thursday, which aims to position the country as a leader in the field of AI. Modi welcomed leaders of the various participating countries at the summit venue, Bharat Mandapam, on Wednesday, the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) said in an official statement. On the sidelines, he will also hold bilateral meetings with several world leaders attending the summit. PTI

Expo extended till Sat, closed to public today

New Delhi: The government has decided to extend the timeline of the expo being held at the AI Impact Summit by one day till Saturday. An official statement said the exhibition will remain open to the public on February 21. The statement also said that in order to avoid inconvenience to the public in view of access-restricted events, the expo will remain closed to the public on Thursday. The timings of the expo have already been extended up to 8 pm. OUR BUREAU

Make AI easy to use, urges Zoom COO

New Delhi: People in India are willing to adopt new technologies, and companies here should focus on making their products easy to use, said Zoom's COO Aparna Bawa. "In India people are willing to embrace new technologies and new things... Cellphones are there in the remote corners... So, why should India not embrace AI, and there are billions of people, if you can make things easy to use... if you can do and you guys are capable of doing that... I would not think of it as the race has been taken over by two big countries, the world is for you." PTI

AGI achievable in the next 5-8 years: Google DeepMind CEO

LOT IN STORE. Demis Hassabis says the next 10 years will be a golden era for scientific discovery using AI

Sindhu Hariharan
New Delhi

We are at a threshold moment for artificial intelligence with Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) on the horizon in the next 5-8 years, said Google DeepMind co-founder and CEO Demis Hassabis on Wednesday. Speaking to a full house at the AI Impact Summit in New Delhi, Hassabis said they are seeing the beginning of what autonomous systems can do, and he is personally motivated to use AI to advance science, medicine, climate change and other areas. "We are going to need many more such international summits to discuss and collaborate on the opportunities and risks of AI," he said. In a fireside chat with Professor Balaram



CATCH THEM YOUNG. Students should lean in to become proficient with AI tools, said Hassabis

Ravindran of IIT-Madras, Hassabis said the ecosystem is still missing some important elements in reaching AGI. AI systems still can't continuously learn and train themselves and are quite in-

consistent, he said. "They also possess a sort of 'jagged intelligence', and are capable of gold medals in Olympiads, but still make mistakes in elementary math," he added. However, the next 10

years will be a golden era for scientific discovery using AI, he predicted. INDIA'S ROLE On India's role in global AI race, Hassabis said he was

"incredibly impressed" about the energy of India and the positivity around AI. "Students should really lean in to become proficient with AI tools, it will give them a superpower in whatever they do," said the Nobel Laureate heading Google's Deepmind. Hassabis said he was "cautiously optimistic about AI systems as they stand today". "We are on the cusp of an incredible transformation that will revolutionise science," he said. "While I do believe in human ingenuity to advance AI, we also need to address societal challenges," he added. When quizzed about the two key risks with AI systems, he flagged the risks of cybersecurity and bio hacks using AI. At GDM, we are working to make sure our "defences stronger than offences", he said.

Personal AI on devices a unique opportunity for the nation: Intel India head

Sindhu Hariharan
New Delhi

Personal AI on devices, or Edge AI as it is called, will be a unique opportunity for India to succeed, said Santhosh Viswanathan, Vice-President and Managing Director, Intel, India Region.

DATA CENTERS While India has already started making its move in the data centre segment, the AI applications will take off on Edge devices such as mobiles, AI-enabled PCs and other gadgets and there is still headroom for growth in it, Viswanathan told busi-

nessline on the sidelines of the AI Impact Summit. Noting that the PC penetration in Indian households is less than 10 per cent, he said there is a need to reimagine that infrastructure — something Intel is now doing with AI PCs. "I think the model of AI in India is going to be very different from the model of AI everywhere else in the world," he said. "Rather than looking at how to build AI at scale, India's approach will be to see how to get AI to different citizen use cases such as a POS machine, DigiYatra kiosk and other such solutions. It's what you can call the UPI model of AI that is



Santhosh Viswanathan, Vice-President and Managing Director, Intel, India Region

relevant for India," he said. Speaking about the chip design firm's semiconductor manufacturing journey, Viswanathan said they had taken the first step in the

'I think the model of AI in India is going to be very different from the model of AI everywhere else in the world'

form of the partnership with Tata. "I think it's a journey that will be multi-years, and you will see it unravel as it plays out," he said. Tata Group and Intel entered into a strategic alliance, formalised through an MoU in December 2025,

whereby the companies are set to explore joint efforts across consumer and enterprise hardware enablement, semiconductor manufacturing, systems manufacturing and advanced packaging within India. Intel and Tata also plan to evaluate local manufacturing and packaging of Intel products at Tata Electronics' upcoming Fab and OSAT facilities, including opportunities for advanced packaging in India. The partnership, among other things, will also focus on scaling AI PC solutions tailored for India's consumer and enterprise markets, leveraging Intel's AI compute reference designs

and Tata Electronics' EMS capabilities. Similarly, Intel is also said to be working with other EMS companies and ODMs, such as Bhagwati Products Ltd, Dixon Technologies India Ltd, Kaynes Technology India Ltd, Optiemus Electronics Ltd and others, for entry-level laptop manufacturing in the country. Commenting on the expansion of the ISM 2.0 programme, he appreciated the government's move, and said they will look at working with policymakers on key aspects, such as increasing the data centre footprint and the penetration of PCs and other AI-enabled devices.

CHOCK-A-BLOCK



TECH-SAVVY INDIA. Visitors seen in large numbers on the third day of the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi on Wednesday SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Qualcomm's VC arm to invest \$150 m in Indian AI start-ups, ties up with Sarvam

Our Bureau
Chennai

Technology major Qualcomm has announced plans to invest up to \$150 million in Indian AI start-ups, with a particular focus on AI for automotive, Internet of Things (IoT), robotics and mobile devices. The investments will be deployed through Qualcomm Ventures, the group's venture capital division, and will invest in start-ups across all stages. The announcement was made by Cristiano Amon, President and CEO, Qualcomm Incorporated, at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi. 'A NEW PHASE' "Through our new Strategic AI Venture Fund, Qualcomm is investing in companies that are advancing the next



Cristiano Amon, President and CEO of Qualcomm REUTERS

chapter of AI in India. AI is entering a new phase where intelligence is built directly into devices and systems people depend on every day, including smartphones, PCs, cars, industrial machines, robots. India's start-up ecosystem has a critical role in this shift," said Amon in a statement. Qualcomm has been investing in Indian start-ups since 2007, backing more than 40 companies. At the summit, Qualcomm also announced a partnership with Indian AI start-up Sarvam. The collaboration will bring together Sarvam's AI models and Qualcomm hardware and software capabilities to drive innovation across smartphones, PCs, Extended Reality(XR), data centers and other related domains. As part of engagement, the companies intend to work together to develop a Sovereign AI Experience Suite, which will run real world AI application on a wide range of devices and help deploy solutions across key sectors such as governance, education, healthcare, agriculture and commerce. The partnership will also focus on supporting multiple Indian languages and dialects.

Galgotias University faces backlash for passing off Chinese robodog, Korean drone as in-house innovations

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The government on Wednesday asked Galgotias University to vacate the premises of AI Impact Summit after it was found passing off a Chinese-made robodog and a Korean-made drone as innovations developed in-house by its Centre of Excellence. What surfaced as a sideshow over misleading claims on Tuesday snowballed into a full-fledged controversy on Wednesday, hitting international headlines and overshadowing other discussions about the summit on social media. VIRAL TOPIC From social media to the mainstream and Opposition parties, the Galgotias University controversy remained the main topic of dis-



COPY CAT. A university representative said the robotic dog was developed at the University's Centre of Excellence

cussion connected to the AI Summit. On Tuesday, a university representative, identified as Neha Singh, told DD News that a robotic dog being displayed at the stall was called ORION and that it had been developed in-house at the University's Centre of Excellence. In a video that later be-

came viral, she was seen claiming that the university had also developed a soccer drone, which was also displayed at the expo. She claimed that from end-to-end engineering to application of the soccer drone, everything was done in-house at the university. Soon, social media users

flagged that the robodog had been made by Chinese firm Unitree and is commercially available for sale. Later, it was also pointed out that the soccer drone was known as Striker V3 ARF with origins in South Korea. Reacting to the issue on Wednesday morning, the government asked the university to vacate the premises. However, representatives of the university kept defending their claims as a "mere misrepresentation", and claimed that their statements were misconstrued. The university representatives did not move out of the venue, claiming they had received no instruction to do so. OPPN SLAMS GOVT The whole issue turned into a big drama at the venue with the electricity to the university pavilion being cut off as

their representatives tried to brazen out the storm. Meanwhile, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi slammed the government on the social media, saying: "Instead of leveraging India's talent and data, the AI summit is a disorganised PR spectacle — Indian data up for sale, Chinese products showcased." Eventually, the university contingent moved out of the venue. By evening, it released a fresh statement apologising profusely for the confusion created at the summit and pinning the blame on its representatives. "One of our representatives manning the pavilion was ill-informed. She was not aware of the technical origins of the products, and in her enthusiasm to be on camera, gave factually incorrect information even though she was not authorised to speak to the press," the university stated.

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

After Galgotias University faced criticism at the AI Summit Expo for showcasing a commercially available Chinese robotic dog as an in-house innovation, Wipro also drew scrutiny for displaying a similar robot called TJ. Sources familiar with the matter, however, said Wipro's demo focused on its InspectAI solution, not the robot itself. The robot, presented by the university as Orion, was identified by observers as Unitree Go2 developed by Chinese robotics company Unitree, triggering a broader controversy at the India AI Impact Summit. On the other hand, Wipro, on its website, shared that InspectAI brings computer vision models for addressing

the visual inspection, labelling and surveillance needs of various industries. Speaking to the media at the expo, Wipro said: "TJ can go where it's risky for human beings to enter. We can carry out inspections with this robot. It has an in-built AI model that can detect harmful scenarios, such as rusting, and prevent the possibility of accidents." WHAT IS INSPECT AI? InspectAI essentially collects data from inspection sources, including UAVs, magnetic crawlers and various imaging assets, such as spectral, LiDAR and other advanced cameras. Operators can plan the image-capture path and replay previously recorded inspection paths. Wipro explained on its website that InspectAI provides an effective means of inspecting and capturing

valuable data from field assets. The solution helps create a digital data platform, enabling proactive asset management, while increasing the overall safety on rigs and other assets. Its integrated platform can gather data from drones, cameras and crawlers. InspectAI can then process and analyse these multi source inputs using AI to identify anomalies related to surface conditions, such as corrosion, substrate, missing parts and the detection of foreign objects. businessline. Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD, the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper. A CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

AI not a replacement for expertise: Airbus executive

New Delhi: Artificial intelligence is a responsible enabler designed to augment human capability and not a replacement for expertise, Airbus India chief Jurgen Westermeier said on Wednesday. The President and Managing Director for India and South Asia at Airbus also said that AI should be seen as a bridge that helps to be more efficient and optimise resources on the way to the net-zero goals. **PH**

Skye Air Mobility ties up with Arrive AI, Ottonomy

New Delhi: Hyperlocal drone delivery platform Skye Air Mobility, in partnership with Arrive AI and Ottonomy, on Wednesday demonstrated the end-to-end autonomous commerce delivery system at the India AI Impact Summit here. The solution integrates Skye Air's aerial drones with smart infrastructure and ground robotics to deliver packages directly to customers' doorsteps without any human intervention. **PH**

India to add \$2 t tech m-cap in next decade: Accel

New Delhi: India is poised to add nearly \$2 trillion in market capitalisation through technology over the next decade, creating large companies, which will reshape the country's economic landscape, said VC firm Accel on Wednesday. **PH**

AI disruption to software industry is real, says Zoho's Sridhar Vembu

Sindhu Hariharan
New Delhi

Artificial intelligence models have become much better in the last few months, and the disruption to the software industry is very real, Sridhar Vembu, Founder and Chief Scientist at Zoho Corp, said on Wednesday.

"AI models, such as those from Anthropic, have gotten much better in the last two months and this is accelerating the pace of software development. What would have taken a human engineer maybe two to three months, by their own assessment, they're able to do it in two, three days. So, we are able to at least get to prototypes very fast," he told *businessline* on the sidelines of the AI Summit.

He urged software companies to try new things and experiment across areas to see which approach works.

Abundantia, invideo sign pact to launch AI-driven film production studio

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Abundantia Entertainment has inked a partnership with global AI video technology leader invideo to launch an AI-driven film production studio. The partnership is backed by an investment of ₹100 crore.

The partnership will leverage Abundantia's creative and film-making ecosystem and invideo's advanced generative-video technology to reimagine how films are conceptualised, developed and produced, a statement added.

AI-DRIVEN FILMS

The companies will deploy the development and production corpus towards the creation of five AI-driven films over the next three years, under Abundantia's AI-powered storytelling division aiON.

Vikram Malhotra, Founder and CEO, Abundantia Entertainment, said, "Our partnership with invideo allows us to design a future-facing creative studio

Yotta, Nvidia join hands to build \$2-b AI supercluster

FRONTIER TECH. Partnership will deploy 20,736 Blackwell Ultra GPUs by August

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Yotta Data Services and Nvidia will partner to form one of Asia's largest AI superclusters, deploying 20,736 liquid-cooled Blackwell Ultra GPUs by August, with an investment exceeding \$2 billion, a statement said.

With this, India joins a select group of geographies to host frontier-scale AI infrastructure.

The American technology company Nvidia will establish one of the largest Asia-Pacific DGX cloud clusters within Yotta's HGX B300 Blackwell Ultra supercluster, leveraging Blackwell Ultra GPUs under a four-year engagement valued at over \$1 billion. The combined capital commitments reflect a sustained and long-term demand for high-performance AI infrastructure.

Yotta, which runs tier-4 data centres in Navi Mumbai and Greater Noida, currently operates over 10,000 Nvidia GPUs live in production, with another 8,000 Nvidia GPUs going live within the next quarter. The company has outlined a roadmap to scale up beyond 80,000 Nvidia GPUs by FY27, supported by phased infrastructure expansion and long-term capacity planning. At scale, this trajectory posi-



STRATEGIC PACT. Sunil Gupta, CEO and Co-Founder, Yotta Data Services, with Jensen Huang, CEO and President, Nvidia

tions India as a high-growth AI market and a structurally significant compute hub within the global AI ecosystem.

"India is emerging as one of the world's most important AI markets, driven by extraordinary talent and a bold national vision. Yotta's deployment of one of the largest Nvidia Blackwell Ultra superclusters creates advanced AI infrastructure capable of training frontier-scale models and delivering AI at population scale. Expanding AI factory capacity in India strengthens Nvidia's regional footprint while supporting India's ambition to build secure, sovereign, and globally competitive AI," said Jensen Huang, Co-Founder and CEO, Nvidia.

The supercluster will be deployed at Yotta's 60 MW D2 hyperscale data centre within the Greater Noida DC campus, scalable to 250 MW,

and supported by Yotta's Navi Mumbai DC campus, scalable to 2 GW.

Yotta has established a long-term platform capable of scaling up beyond one million GPUs in the next three to five years, as India's AI ecosystem accelerates.

"This Nvidia Blackwell Ultra supercluster reinforces India's position in the global AI value chain. Our capital strategy is focused on building scalable infrastructure that serves both national priorities and international AI demand," said Darshan Hir-anandani, Co-Founder and Chairman, Yotta Data Services.

INDIA AI MISSION

Alongside the DGX Cloud deployment, Yotta is committing over 10,000 Nvidia B300 GPUs from the AI supercluster to the IndiaAI Mission, supporting sovereign Indian foundation

model development, research institutions, startups, and population-scale public AI platforms.

This parallel allocation ensures that domestic AI priorities advance alongside global AI capacity expansion. Access to large-scale Blackwell infrastructure within the country reduces dependence on offshore compute.

SHAKTI STUDIO

Beyond infrastructure scale, Yotta is augmenting its Shakti Studio AI platform with Nvidia Nemotron open models, Nvidia NIM microservices, and access to the full Nvidia AI Enterprise software suite.

Through Shakti Studio, developers in India gain access to the Nvidia Nemotron family of open models, including model weights, training datasets and recipes, enabling transparent fine-tuning, customisation, and sovereign AI development at scale.

"India's AI ambition requires sustained, high-performance compute at scale. By combining Blackwell Ultra infrastructure with open models like Nvidia Nemotron and the full Nvidia AI stack, we are enabling developers to build sovereign, globally competitive AI applications from India," said Sunil Gupta, Co-Founder, MD and CEO, Yotta Data Services.

L&T, Nvidia to build GW-scale AI factory infrastructure in India

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Larsen & Toubro announced a partnership with Nvidia on Wednesday, at the India AI Summit in Mumbai, to develop gigawatt-scale AI factory infrastructure in India, under the country's IndiaAI Mission.

The venture will combine L&T's engineering and infrastructure capabilities with Nvidia's hardware and software stack — including GPUs, CPUs, networking, storage platforms, and the Nvidia AI Enterprise software suite.

The immediate plan involves scaling up Nvidia GPU cluster deployments at L&T's 300-acre Chennai data centre to 30 MW, and at the new 40 MW data centre under development in Mumbai.

AI MISSION

The venture will combine L&T's engineering and infrastructure capabilities with Nvidia's hardware and software stack

The infrastructure is intended to serve domestic enterprises as well as global hyperscalers and cloud providers seeking Indian AI capacity.

FOCUS AREAS

Target sectors include manufacturing, energy, financial services, healthcare and public services.

L&T described the design as "sovereign by default", meaning AI workloads, data, and models can be built and deployed within India while

remaining compatible with global systems.

L&T Chairman and Managing Director SN Subrahmanyan said the investment would provide the secure and scalable foundation needed to move Indian enterprises from AI pilots to production-scale deployment.

Nvidia Co-Founder and CEO Jensen Huang framed the partnership within a broader global AI infrastructure buildout, citing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's stated goal of positioning India as a hub for AI across the Global South.

The venture will also support AI deployments using Nvidia Omniverse within L&T group companies, including LTTS' industrial automation work, and agentic AI initiatives at LTM and LTFS.

NPCI ties up with Nvidia to advance sovereign AI model for digital payments

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) on Wednesday announced its collaboration with Nvidia to scale up and advance its sovereign AI model capabilities purpose-built for India's payments ecosystem.

The initiative will support the evolving requirements of large-scale, real-time pay-

ment systems, with an emphasis on trust, resilience, security, and ecosystem enablement, NPCI said in a statement.

DOMAIN EXPERTISE

The collaboration brings together NPCI's domain expertise in building and operating population-scale payments infrastructure with Nvidia's advanced AI and accelerated computing platforms. As part of this en-

agement, NPCI will use Nvidia Nemotron — a family of open models with open weights, training data and recipes — in its model development journey to create a payments-native AI foundation model aligned with India's regulatory and data sovereignty requirements.

NPCI's use of AI has been guided by practical requirements emerging from operating payment systems at scale.

AI COMMITMENT



RECORD RESPONSIBILITY. Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology Ashwini Vaishnaw (second from right) displays the Guinness World Record certifying the highest number of pledges taken within 24 hours by students for responsible use of AI, at the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in New Delhi on Wednesday. Guinness World Records Adjudicator Pravin Patel (second from left) announced that 2,50,946 pledges were received during the summit against the targeted 5,000 **SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA**

Embracing AI is the best card to succeed: Ivana Bartoletti of Wipro

bl.interview

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

India is navigating a pivotal era as its "techno-legal" approach to AI policy moves in the right direction, Ivana Bartoletti, Wipro's Global Chief Privacy and AI Governance Officer said at the India AI Impact Summit.

Bartoletti emphasised that, instead of fearing AI, it should be embraced as a vital tool for success.

Edited excerpts:

As a policy head, what kind of feedback and suggestions are you getting from the global companies here?

The atmosphere here is fantastic. Having attended other global events, like the Paris AI Summit last year, I particularly appreciate the openness of this forum. Seeing students and young people involved is vital, as the core theme is the democratisation of technology.

The idea that AI must benefit all of society is central here. It is not just about driving economic growth, but also ensuring that growth is equitably distributed. In this

context, governance is not merely a compliance exercise or risk management — it is an institutional capability.

It is about the power of a business or a country to adopt these tools and govern their use effectively. India's unique approach to this is both impressive and important.

Do you think India should look to global companies when it comes to regulations because India still has soft regulation?

There is no single 'right' way to regulate. The EU has its framework, and the US uses a mix of State-level privacy laws and governance models. India's approach is particularly interesting because it leverages existing legislation first. While there are questions over whether the DPDP Act is sufficient to address all potential harms, India is not pre-empting everything with new laws. Instead, it is focusing on 'full-cycle accountability' — the techno-legal approach.

Unlike the European Parliament, which might pass 300 laws in a year, India's legislative process is more deliberate. This makes the 'soft law' approach, using

This is a completely new field that AI has created. We need professionals in this field, as much as we will need people who are able to translate the technology into public policy

IVANA BARTOLETTI,
Global Chief Privacy and AI Governance Officer, Wipro

guidelines for responsible AI and cybersecurity, crucial.

These guidelines can eventually evolve into hard law, but starting this way allows for agility. When you combine this regulatory style with India's proven capacity for massive technological rollouts, like UPI, you get a unique model that the rest of the world should watch closely.

Do you think we are going with a techno-legal way because we don't have our own AI models yet, before going for hard laws?

That is a good point, but the



problem is that AI systems don't just pop up. The challenge is that you are not going to change this overnight. These are issues that go way beyond India. They are challenges that every country at the moment is grappling with, including Europe, where I come from.

It is not just large language models; there are small language models (SLMs) too. This is very important: how we use these systems, augment them and fine-tune them for use cases. I believe that there is big potential.

Fine-tuning these models to be trained in India is key, because I am fully aware that such models are built with

data coming from the web. The data here does not come from the Global South. Even these LLMs reflect the culture of the Global North.

It is important to have systems that are fine-tuned and trained on Indian data, representing the cultural norms, languages, dialects, etc.

Do you think we are going in the right direction — working on foundational models depending on the global models?

No, I think this is a combination of things. The good thing is to develop smaller models — not just focus on large models. Open source is also important.

The other good thing is using the models that we have to create applications that can be used locally by companies and businesses in India. So, it is a combination; it is not just one side for India.

There are several discussions around AI's impact on jobs. Being a part of a leading IT firm, do you think that's happening across sectors?

AI is going to be a threat for people who do not use AI. My fear is that people are using

AI in a different way, also by doing what is called automation. They trust such AI because the answers look structured.

That is not necessarily good. You have got to teach people to question. Skilling should involve adopting a critical yet positive approach to artificial intelligence.

Secondly, companies have a duty to provide these opportunities, as does the government in influencing public policy at that level. The other thing which is really important is to make sure that we understand what new jobs are coming around us.

This is a completely new field that AI has created. We need professionals in this field, as much as we will need people who are able to translate the technology into public policy.

So, there will be jobs that will be created and there will be jobs that will change. It is really important to look at this and make sure that people are aware, not worried. They should be ready to embrace it and be told that embracing is important. It is the best way to succeed. To remain valuable in the market, one must learn to work with AI, not to fear it.

Realty check

SC’s criticism of RERA underscores need for reform

Last week, a Supreme Court bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant expressed dismay over the functioning of the Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA), and went so far as to say that RERA might as well shut shop. Having come into being in May 2017 after the enactment of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development Act), 2016, RERA has not lived up to its billing.



The law was framed as a response to builders defalcating on buyers’ money by diverting the funds collected to other projects, not completing projects on time or deciding not to do so, and simply not returning the money collected. There was a rash of such scams, with Unitech, Jaypee and Amrapali being among the high profile ones, in the two decades or so till 2010. To be fair, the scale of defalcation may have fallen since the law, enacted by most States with some variations, came into force. It mandates registration of projects over 500 sq m, with a crucial requirement such as the builder depositing 70 per cent of the money received from buyers into an escrow account. Buyers are supposed to be paid penalty for delays in possession, or can claim his deposit within 45 days of default on this count. Project details such as carpet area and layout cannot be altered without consent. But project delays continue, and buyers are unable to get their money back easily even after securing a favourable order from the Real Estate Appellate Tribunal.

RERA orders should ideally be followed up by the police or municipality, for them to be effective. There is no coordination between RERA bodies in the State and these civic bodies — whether as a matter of design or accident, it is hard to say. Ideally, violations of building plans, municipal rules or defalcation should be enough for the regulator to cancel a builder’s licence, a power that it can exercise without looking over its shoulder. Yet, it fights shy of doing so, perhaps on account of the lobbies at work. In a digital scenario, it should be possible for the penalty to be deposited into the buyer’s account immediately on delay. But it is well known that builders manage to get their deadlines extended on the flimsiest of pretexts, without fear of repercussions. The appellate tribunals do not stick to their deadline of 60 days to settle complaints. So, the story of buyers’ funds being locked up for long periods persists, despite a law being in place.

For better enforcement of the RERA Act, inter-agency coordination should improve. Buyer-seller contracts should be standardised to rid it of unfair clauses that hurt gullible buyers. RERA bodies must publish regular reports on registrations and complaint redressals, including cancellation of licences. Their appointments, as the apex court has observed, need an overhaul to ensure that a clique does not run the show. Finally, real estate business is characterised by a huge asymmetry of power and information between buyer and seller. The law and its enforcement must empower the consumer.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

EUROPE

Iran wants Trump to pull an Obama

After Iran violently suppressed protests in 2009, President Obama sought to trade US silence for nuclear negotiations. Now Tehran is hoping President Trump will make the same mistake. That was the logic of Tuesday’s nuclear talks in Geneva. Though the military firepower that Mr. Trump has sent to the region leaves reason to wonder about his plans. The President promised to come to the aid of the Iranian people in January, as they were massacred by their rulers at greater scale than ever before. This should be a moment to confront the true nature of the Iranian regime. Yet US officials are again mired in discussions about nuclear enrichment, stockpiled uranium and regional consortia. (NEW YORK, FEBRUARY 17)



In the face of history, Japan’s discomfort telling

History, that most straight-talking of guests, arrived in Munich on the weekend to the consternation of Tokyo. If you listened closely at the 62nd Munich Security Conference, you could almost hear the faint clatter of teacups rattling in Tokyo. The cause was not seismic, but truthfulness: Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi had brought the past into the present. Wang’s remarks about Japan’s wartime past and its postwar obligations were not theatre designed for the occasion; they were drawn from the same ledger that underpins the Asia-Pacific order the United States and its allies helped write in 1945. The return of China’s Taiwan region to its motherland, Japan’s renunciation of militarism, and the legal architecture of peace were not Chinese inventions but Allied conclusions and consensus. (BEIJING, FEBRUARY 17)



An expanded Trans-Pacific alliance will be beneficial

UNIQUE SYNERGY. Apart from providing a defence against supply-chain blackmail, businesses within this bloc would enjoy unprecedented access to scale, specialised skills, and technical knowhow



PRITAM BANERJEE

The global economy is currently navigating a sea of uncertainty, as the post-Cold War rules-based trading system is increasingly undermined by intensifying geopolitical rivalries. While this order was never perfect, it provided the essential stability for middle powers to grow and pursue their national interests. However, as we enter the second quarter of the 21st century, the strategic options for these nations appear to be shrinking. Middle powers are a diverse group. They include mature economies like the European Union, Japan, and Canada that face demographic declines and diminishing global importance, as well as surging emerging powers like India, Brazil and Indonesia. Despite their differences, these nations share a vital common goal: managing current geopolitical and economic turbulence without compromising their pursuit of national interests. To achieve this, they must salvage a rules-based system of global trade that protects them from the “weaponisation” of demand, supply, and technology. This requires forming cohesive alliances to act in concert. An expanded Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) offers the ideal platform for this collective defence.

A NEW ECONOMIC GRAVITY The current CPTPP consists of 12 countries across three continents, including major economies like Japan, Australia, Canada, and the UK. With the EU, Indonesia, and South Korea already seeking entry, the addition of India, Brazil, and the Philippines would transform the pact into a massive, united counterweight to any dominant power seeking to destabilise the global economy.

In this configuration, India and the EU would serve as the two primary anchors of a trans-regional alliance. This bloc could effectively counter what Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney described as the “weaponisation of global interdependence”. The numbers tell a compelling story of potential influence: **Global reach:** This extended CPTPP would include 13 G20 members. **Market power:** It would account for roughly 45 per cent of global GDP and over a third of global trade. **Demographic weight:** With a combined population of over three billion, it would represent nearly 40 per cent of humanity.

THE ENGINE OF GLOBAL GROWTH This expanded group would be responsible for approximately 40 per cent of global GDP expansion in 2026, with India alone accounting for 17 per cent of that global growth. As India’s growth trajectory continues, it is projected to contribute 20-25 per cent of all global GDP growth by 2030. This surge, alongside contributions from Indonesia, Brazil, the Philippines, and Vietnam, will balance the falling economic shares of mature powers like EU, Japan, and Canada. By the end of the current decade, this bloc could account for over 50 per cent of global economic growth, providing it with tremendous leverage.

THE ‘THIRD ALTERNATIVE’ This economic alliance between mature and emerging middle powers would be more than just a trade pact; it would be the basis for trans-regional economic alliance underpinned by shared principles of open markets and

As India ascends to the status of a global great power, its leadership in crafting this “third alternative” will be crucial

democratic accountability. By integrating the world’s most dynamic economies, the expanded CPTPP would create a unique synergy: **A growth-innovation engine:** It would fuse the demographic dividends and rapid economic expansion of the emerging world with the sophisticated technology and deep capital of mature powers. **Dominance in global value chains:** Businesses within this bloc would enjoy unprecedented access to scale, specialised skills, and technical know-how, empowering them to drive innovation and lead global value chains. **A shield against economic coercion:** Their combined market heft would provide the ultimate defence against supply-chain “blackmail”. By establishing comprehensive mechanisms for concerted action within the CPTPP framework, these nations can effectively counter the weaponisation of trade by dominant powers. **Forging digital sovereignty:** Middle powers have been relegated to largely being consumers in a digital economy dominated by digital giants from the US and China. An amended digital trade chapter based on mutual trust could act as a catalyst, leveraging the bloc’s massive talent pool to create “digital champions” and a more balanced and competitive global digital ecosystem. **Salvaging global institutions:** Acting in concert, this group could drive the crucial compromises needed to revitalise the WTO and other Bretton Woods organisations, such as the World Bank and IMF. Furthermore, it could provide the momentum to reimagine UN bodies like the UNDP and UNCTAD.

THE ‘GRAND BARGAIN’ For this vision to materialise, the alliance must move beyond traditional trade rhetoric. Mature powers like the EU, UK, Japan and Canada must acknowledge the unique developmental imperatives of emerging economies. This will require ‘Grand Bargains’ in sensitive areas such as labour standards,

environmental regulations, digital trade, and intellectual property. Success lies in flexibility, specifically through carve-outs and exemptions that allow emerging members the policy space to grow while remaining within a high-standard framework. The groundwork for this is already laid. The India-UK and India-EU Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) serve as vital “game-changers”, providing a practical roadmap for the brave compromises required from both sides. These bilateral successes prove that the gap between mature standards and emerging realities is bridgeable. **INDIA’S STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE** As India ascends to the status of a global great power, its leadership in crafting this “third alternative” will be crucial. Given its rapidly rising economic trajectory and burgeoning technological capabilities, India will act as the primary force multiplier for such an expanded CPTPP. This leadership will not be a radical departure from India’s diplomatic history, but rather an evolution of it: **A new non-alignment:** Just as India spearheaded the Non-Aligned Movement to provide a “third way” for post-colonial nations during the Cold War, it can now lead a redefined CPTPP to protect middle powers from modern great-power coercion. **Incremental but defining:** Since India is already negotiating or has signed FTAs with nearly every current CPTPP member, joining the bloc is a logical incremental step. **Global consequences:** While the step may be incremental, the consequences would be world-defining, shifting the centre of gravity towards a more equitable international order. By leading the evolution towards this expanded CPTPP, India can ensure that the 21st century is defined by cooperation and mutual interest, rather than fragmentation and conflict.

The writer is Head, Centre for WTO Studies, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade. Views are personal

Effect of the new rules on bank lending to brokers

The RBI ban on bank funding for proprietary trades from April 2026 will raise costs, force deleveraging

bl.explainer

Akshata Gorde

The RBI has tightened rules governing how banks lend to capital market intermediaries, raising concern among brokerage firms, particularly those with large proprietary trading operations. While the move is aimed at curbing excessive leverage and strengthening financial stability, here’s an explainer on why brokers say the transition could disrupt funding and trading activity.

What has the RBI changed? The RBI has mandated that all bank lending to capital market intermediaries must be fully backed by eligible collateral and subject to continuous monitoring. Crucially, banks are now barred from financing brokers’ proprietary trading or investment positions. However, lending for operational requirements, such as

working capital, settlement mismatches and market-making, is still permitted. Banks are also explicitly allowed to fund margin trading undertaken by clients through stockbrokers. **Why does the proprietary trading restriction matter so much?** For many brokers, bank credit was a relatively low-cost source of leverage for proprietary trading desks. With this route shut, brokers will have to either cut back positions, deploy more internal capital or shift to alternative funding sources, which are typically more expensive. This directly impacts leverage, trading volumes, and short-term profitability, especially for firms where prop trading is a meaningful contributor to earnings.

What do the new collateral rules do? The RBI has introduced standardised collateral haircuts, 40 per cent on listed equities; 25 per cent on sovereign gold



NEW NORMS. Will push up cost of funds for proprietary trading p11

bonds, mutual funds, and REITs/ETF units; and 15-40 per cent on debt mutual funds and debt instruments. While this brings clarity and consistency for banks, it may reduce the effective borrowing value of pledged assets for brokers, tightening funding further in some cases.

Are client-facing brokers affected?

Brokers focused on client-driven businesses such as cash equities, derivatives broking, advisory and wealth management are expected to see limited impact on core operations. The clear regulatory backing for bank funding of client margin trading is positive for this segment, removing a long-standing grey area for lenders. **Why are brokers planning representations to the RBI?** Brokers are not opposing the objective of reducing systemic risk but are concerned about near-term disruption. Industry representations are expected to focus on transition timelines, operational clarity, and the cumulative impact of higher funding costs. In the short run, brokers warn of selective unwinding of proprietary positions and some pressure on market liquidity. Over the longer term, the rules are likely to push the industry towards lower leverage, stronger balance sheets, and more conservative business models.

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Mis-selling by banks This refers to ‘Wrong practice’ (February 18). One area where mis-selling is frequently observed is the sale of third-party products such as mutual funds and insurance without adequate assessment of customer suitability. The allocation of sales targets to staff of financial institutions creates additional pressure. When such targets are often linked to revenue and profitability objectives it affects employee morale. There is also a need for the RBI to closely monitor the sale of complex derivative products to industrial houses. At a time when volatility in the foreign exchange market is rising, the sale of derivative products in the name of managing interest rate and exchange

rate risks, without clearly explaining the associated risks and conducting proper suitability assessments, can result in significant losses when market conditions turn adverse. As such mis-selling in case of both liability and asset products need to be monitored. **Srinivasan Velamur** Chennai **SB a/c balance** Apropos, ‘Banks must not levy penalty for failure to maintain minimum balance in SB a/cs (February 18). While banks do give different rates of interest on depositors’ money and charge different rates of interest on their loans subject to their credit-deposit ratio or liquidity position, charging

penalties on savings account holders for not maintaining minimum balances is unfair. This issue has been rightly identified by the parliamentary committee report which has suggested new guidelines in this matter. Banks have to realise that their business to a large extent is driven by these small savers, who also avail themselves of other types of investment products which bring huge incomes to the banks. **Katuru Durga Prasad Rao** Hyderabad **Fiscal devolution** While the article ‘Finance panels, and needs of local bodies’ (February 18) highlights the importance of fiscal devolution, it overlooks the data deficit and administrative

bottlenecks that cripple State Finance Commissions (SFCs). Local bodies often lack standardised, audited accounting systems, making it nearly impossible for panels to accurately assess the vertical and horizontal fiscal gaps. Furthermore, the non-synchronous cycles between Central and State commissions lead to delayed fund releases. Strengthening local finances requires not just more grants, but digital infrastructure for revenue collection and a mandatory Action Taken Report (ATR) mechanism to ensure SFC recommendations are actually implemented by State legislatures. **PD Sankaranarayanan** Kumaramputhur, Kerala **Pulses import from US** Apropos ‘Need to import pulses to meet domestic demand’ (February 18). Unless the factsheet of the US trade deal is revealed, farmers will continue to be concerned. Import of pulses from the US must come with quantitative restrictions and right to revision. Also, at no stage should GM pulses slip into Indian shores. Farmers must be encouraged to produce commodities in short supply, including pulses, through incentives. Finally, vast areas of fallow lands must be identified and leased to farmers to cultivate pulses. This will help abate the demand-supply gap as well as offer economic succour to farming communities. **Rajiv Magal** Halekere Village, Karnataka

CM
YK

QUICKLY.

Dabur slides 2%, FMCG major rejigs management



Mumbai: Shares of Dabur India fell nearly 2.6 per cent on Wednesday on the NSE to ₹503.50. The stock opened higher at ₹525 but reversed sharply and closed at ₹510.60, down 1.25 per cent over the previous day's close. The sell-off follows a management restructuring announced on Tuesday. Dabur's board redesignated Mohit Malhotra from Whole Time Director & CEO to Whole Time Director & Global CEO. Herjit S Bhalla has been appointed CEO – India Business, effective April 15. Bhalla, 49, brings over 25 years of experience across roles at Unilever, Metro Cash & Carry, and The Hershey Company, where he most recently served as VP Canada & Global Customers. **OUR BUREAU**

SEBI panel to review ESG rating providers framework

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has set up a working group to review the regulatory framework governing ESG Rating Providers (ERPs), following feedback from market participants. The panel includes representatives from issuers, investors, domestic and global ERPs, ESG analysts, legal experts and academia. It will review current rules, examine stakeholder suggestions and recommend measures to improve transparency, reliability and investor confidence in ESG ratings. It will also assess global regulatory developments and suggest alignment with international best practices. A report with policy recommendations will be submitted to SEBI. **OUR BUREAU**

Avadhut Sathe, academy refused fresh access to frozen funds by SAT

NO RELIEF. Judicial pronouncement cannot be subject to modification, says tribunal

Akshata Gorde

The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) has rejected a request by Avadhut Sathe and his academy to continue interim access to frozen bank accounts, holding that the appeal has been finally disposed of and no further orders are warranted. The tribunal rejected the miscellaneous application that sought permission to withdraw ₹2.25 crore a month for operational and legal expenses, and dismissed the plea.

FINAL ORDER The bench said in an order on Monday, “The appeal has been finally disposed of by this Tribunal.” It went on to

observe that “a judicial pronouncement cannot be subject to modification once the judgment has been pronounced,” and that an interim order merges into a final order and therefore cannot be separately continued. The dispute dates to an ex parte interim order-cum show-cause notice issued by the market regulator Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on December 4, 2025, which led to the impoundment of about ₹546 crore and a freeze on bank and demat accounts. The tribunal admitted the appeal and, on January 22, 2026, partly allowed it, reducing the deposit requirement to ₹100 crore and issuing further directions. The appellants had earlier



Avadhut Sathe ASTA WEBSITE

been permitted to withdraw ₹2.25 crore for a month during the proceedings; they now sought continuation of that arrangement.

LIMITED RELIEF

Counsel for Sathe, Abhinav Chandrachud, told the tribunal that the move was not a backdoor attempt to reopen the final order but a limited plea to maintain in-

terim relief while the appellants prepared a Supreme Court challenge. He said his client needed funds “to pay salaries, electricity bills and towards legal expenses” and argued that freezing the accounts would effectively block access to higher remedies. Senior Advocate Chetan Kapadia, representing SEBI, countered that once the ap-

MCX, NSE remove additional margin on gold and silver

Our Bureau

Mumbai

MCX, the country's largest commodity derivatives exchange and the largest stock exchange NSE, have removed the additional margin levied on gold and silver futures contract with the prices cooling off in the last few weeks. The additional margin of 3 per cent levied on gold futures (all contracts of all variants) and 7 per cent levied on silver futures (all contracts of all variants) will be withdrawn with effect from Thursday, said the MCX in a statement. Similarly, with reference to the circular dated February 4, the NSE said the additional margin of 3 per cent levied on gold futures contracts and 7 per cent levied on silver futures contracts will be withdrawn from February 19. On the MCX, gold for April delivery fell by ₹1,210, or

0.80 per cent, to ₹1,53,550 per 10 gr on Wednesday. Silver futures scheduled for delivery in March declined ₹4,685 or 2 per cent, to ₹235,206 per kg. Gold prices have fallen significantly by 4-5 per cent from their February peak. After a record-breaking rally in late 2025 and January, prices peaked at about ₹162,000 per 10 g to about ₹153,550 per 10 g. International spot gold has also eased from above \$5,100 to about \$4,900 an ounce. Similarly, silver futures prices have experienced a significant decline of about 16 per cent to 18 per cent over the last 30 days as of February 18. After hitting a new high of ₹420,000 (January 29) per kg, the February contract on MCX has been on a free fall. The March contract is currently trading at ₹243,622 a kg. Silver on Comex has plunged to \$75 an ounce from \$120 an ounce (January 30).

Sensex, Nifty rise for third straight day, but rout in IT stocks caps gains

Anupama Ghosh

Benchmarks closed in positive territory for the third consecutive session on Wednesday, but the headline gains masked a deepening fault line — the ongoing rout in information technology stocks, which continued to bleed on fresh concerns over artificial intelligence disrupting India's \$300 billion outsourcing industry. The Sensex advanced 283.29 points, or 0.34 per cent, to close at 83,734.25, while the Nifty 50 gained 93.95 points, or 0.37 per cent, to settle at 25,819.35.

The Nifty IT index declined 2.5 per cent, with Antronic's launch of its advanced Claude Sonnet 4.6 model amplifying investor fears around AI-led disruption of Indian IT services. Among Nifty50 losers, Wipro fell 1.73 per cent, Tech Mahindra shed 1.25 per cent, Eternal declined 1.47 per cent, Infosys dropped 1.26 per cent and Adani Enterprises slipped 1.41 per cent.

MAJOR GAINERS Metal, FMCG, and banking stocks provided the counterweight. Kwallity Walls (India) led Nifty gainers with a 4.94 per cent surge, followed by

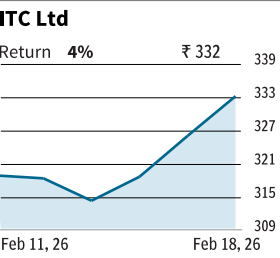
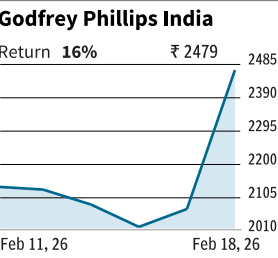
HDFC Life up 3.37 per cent, Tata Steel 2.93 per cent, ITC 2.15 per cent and Bajaj Auto jumped 1.56 per cent. Bank Nifty outperformed, rising 376.80 points or 0.62 per cent to 61,550.80. Nifty Midcap 100 and Smallcap 100 each gained around 0.50 per cent. The BSE breadth was moderately positive — 2,237 advances against 1,955. India VIX eased to 12.39, signalling reduced volatility. Ajit Mishra, SVP Research at Religare Broking, noted that “market participants are attempting to regain control, but indications still favour an extended consolidation phase”.

Godfrey Phillips, VST, ITC light up on price hike

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Shares of cigarette makers Godfrey Phillips, VST Industries and ITC Ltd surged during Wednesday's trading session after reports suggested price hikes across the segment, boosting investor confidence in the sector's revenue outlook. The development follows the government's notification ending the GST compensation cess and introducing a new tobacco tax regime from February 1, moves that could reshape pricing dynamics across the sector. Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said cigarette stocks had



staged a strong rebound after companies implemented decisive price hikes to pass on the recent tax increases. The recovery comes after last month's sharp correction, when the duty hike triggered broad-based selling across the sector. “With pricing adjustments now in place, near-term margin pressures appear more manageable. December-quarter results indicate that

the earlier weakness was largely tax-driven rather than reflective of any structural slowdown in demand,” he said. **PRICE RALLY** Stocks of Godfrey Phillips India led the rally, climbing 20 per cent to settle at ₹2,477.70 on the NSE after hitting the upper circuit of ₹2,478.90, compared with the previous close of ₹2,065.80.

The sharp rise reflected strong buying interest amid expectations that higher pricing could support margins despite regulatory pressures on the tobacco industry. VST Industries shares gained around 3 per cent to close at ₹246.48, reaching a high of ₹248.90 against the prior close of ₹239.65, and ITC ended 2 per cent positive at ₹332.45. Brokerage UBS has maintained a buy rating on ITC and trimmed its target price to ₹395. While higher retail prices could temporarily weigh on volumes, cigarette companies have historically displayed strong pricing power, allowing them to protect profitability even in elevated tax regimes, said Nair.

SBI Funds Management may file DRHP for \$1.5 billion IPO in March

Bloomberg

SBI Funds Management Ltd may file draft papers for an initial public offering next month, according to people familiar with the matter, in what could be the biggest listing by an asset management company in India. The nation's biggest asset manager plans to submit its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) for the IPO that could raise as much as \$1.5 billion in the first half of March, the people said, asking not to be identified because the information is private. **VALUATION TARGET** SBI Funds is targeting a valuation of as much as \$15 billion, one of the people said. That would be a shade lower than ICICI Prudential Asset Management Co's current valuation of \$16.7 billion,



following a \$1.2 billion IPO in December by India's second-largest asset manager. Deliberations are ongoing and details of the offering, including size and timing, could change, they said. A representative for SBI Funds didn't respond to requests for comment. The planned share sale comes as India's market for first-time public offerings has slowed, after two consecutive years of record fundraising. Weaker equity markets have weighed on

valuations, and recent listings — including those of lender Aye Finance Ltd and data analytics firm Fractal Analytics Ltd — have seen subdued demand. SBI Funds has appointed Kotak Mahindra Capital Co, Axis Bank Ltd, SBI Capital Markets Ltd, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Ltd, ICICI Securities Ltd, JM Financial Ltd, and local units of HSBC Holdings Plc, Jefferies Financial Group Inc and Bank of America Corp to manage the share sale, the people said. Citigroup Inc and JPMorgan Chase & Co had earlier opted out of advising on the IPO due to low fees. SBI Funds, with total assets under management of ₹12.5 lakh crore, is jointly owned by State Bank of India and Amundi SA. The partners said last year they plan to sell a combined 10 per cent stake through an IPO.

SEBI imposes ₹1.35 cr penalty on Oriental Trimex, promoters for accounting irregularities

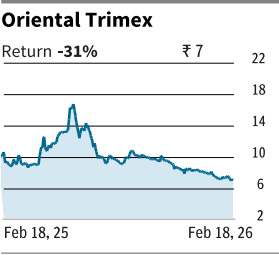
Our Bureau

Chennai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Wednesday levied aggregate monetary penalties of ₹1.35 crore on Oriental Trimex, its promoters and other associated parties for alleged large-scale misstatement and manipulation of the company's financial statements. According to SEBI's adjudication order, this action is the outcome of a multi-year investigation spanning FY17 through FY20.

INFLATED NUMBERS

The investigation revealed that a major portion of reported sales and purchases was inflated through transactions with 22 entities that were non-existent, not traceable at their registered addresses, or not engaged in the company's core marble business. These 22 entities represented a significant share of the company's disclosed



turnover, contributing between approximately 80 per cent and 90 per cent of total revenue and purchases in certain financial years. This concentration raised serious doubts about the reliability and authenticity of Oriental Trimex's financial statements, the SEBI order said. The entities involved are Rajesh Kumar Punia, MD; Savita Punia, Whole-time Director; Om Prakash Sharma, Mirage Marble Private Ltd; Nirmal Marble Ltd; Abhishek Jain, Vivek Seth and Jitendra Surendra Gupta. The stock of Orient Trimex on Wednesday closed at ₹7.12 on the NSE, up 0.71 per cent.

BROKER'S CALL.

Anand Rathi Research

MM FORGINGS (BUY)

Target: ₹600
CMP: ₹472.50
MM Forgings reported ₹71.6 crore EBITDA in Q3FY26 (down 2 per cent year on year), broadly in line with our estimate of ₹70.6 crore. We expect its revenue/EBITDA to clock 13 per cent/18 per cent CAGR over FY26-28E, led by: Expected 7 per cent CAGR in domestic M&HCV volume over FY26-28E on improved economic activities and better replacement demand on GST reforms; likely re-bound in overseas CV sector in FY27/28E on low base and early buying before emission norms (FY27 double-digit), despite muted performance in the near term; and higher-than-industry revenue growth due to new orders, products and higher machining/heavy forging-mix. Standalone revenue grew 11 per cent to ₹405 crore (vs our estimate of ₹376 crore) due to higher export revenue. Domestic grew 14 per cent to ₹256 crore. Exports grew 7 per cent to ₹148 crore. EBITDA fell 2 per cent to ₹71.6 crore vs. our estimate of ₹70.6 crore, due to lower-than-expected gross margin owing to adverse mix. Gross margin contracted 440 bps to 52.9 per cent. PAT fell 19 per cent to ₹25.8 crore, broadly in-line with our estimate of ₹24.9 crore. We trim our FY26e EPS estimate by 8 per cent, due to higher depreciation/interest/tax and lower other income, but raise it by 12-16 per cent for FY27/28E, due to higher revenue and lower interest cost. Thus, we retain BUY rating on the stock with a revised TP of ₹600, valuing it at 16x FY28E EPS. .

PL Capital

IPCA LABORATORIES (BUY)

Target: ₹1,710
CMP: ₹1,480.15
Ipcareported strong EBITDA of ₹530 crore, up 19 per cent year on year, which was 10 per cent above our estimates. Its revenues came in at ₹2,400 crore, up 6.6 per cent; broadly in line with our est. Domestic formulations growth was 12 per cent. Export formulation was up 17 per cent at ₹530 crore above our estimate. . API sales remained flat at ₹410 crore. Export API was up 6 per cent, whereas domestic API declined 14 per cent. Revenues from subsidiaries, including Unichem, were at ₹560 crore. The company has witnessed 400 bps gross margin expansion, ex Unichem, for 9MFY26, which should sustain, given product mix and softer raw material prices. Export API business witnessed recovery in 9MFY26 with 26 per cent growth. Consolidated gross margins improved 230 bps to 72.5 per cent. There was forex loss to the tune of ₹3.5 crore booked under other expenses. Adjusted for forex, other expenses were up 2 per cent. EBITDA adjusted for forex gain came in at ₹530 crore, up 19 per cent vs our est of ₹480 crore. Adjusted for Unichem, EBITDA growth was at 35 per cent with OPM of 25.9 per cent. PAT came at ₹310 crore, up 31 per cent. We believe recovery in API segment, higher margins ex Unichem, steady growth in domestic formulation are the key growth drivers. We maintain our “Buy” rating on stock with revised TP of ₹1,710/share; valuing at 17x EV/EBITDA on FY28E.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Blue Dart Express (₹5,826.20): BUY

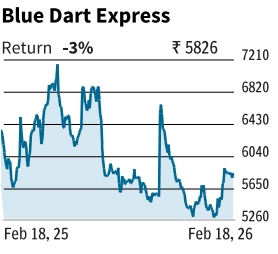
Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau

The stock of Blue Dart Express has been consolidating since early last week. It has been oscillating between ₹5,720 and ₹5,890.

Prior to that, it saw an upward swing in price from about ₹5,200, which began towards the end of January. By crossing the barrier at ₹5,720 early this month, the stock confirmed a double-bottom chart pattern, indicating a bullish trend reversal.

We expect the stock to gain momentum soon and break out of ₹5,890 and rally to ₹6,600 in the near term. Therefore, traders can go long now at



₹5,826 and accumulate if the price dips to ₹5,720. Place stop-loss at ₹5,525. When the stock rises to ₹6,100, trail the stop-loss to ₹5,850. On a rally to ₹6,400, revise the stop-loss to ₹6,250. Exit at ₹6,600. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Day trading guide

25827 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
25650	25500	26000	26200	Displays positive inclination; buy with stop-loss at 25600.	

₹924 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
920	900	930	940	Chart shows a bearish bias; go short with stop-loss at 935.	

₹1373 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1340	1290	1410	1450	Stock might stay sideways; refrain from fresh trades.	

₹332 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
328	325	340	350	Go long on the stock at 332 and 328 with a stop-loss at 320.	

₹264 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
260	252	266	272	Direction is unclear; avoid fresh positions in this stock.	

₹1441 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1420	1400	1445	1475	The stock exhibits a positive bias; buy with stop-loss at 1415.	

₹1219 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1200	1190	1235	1250	Buy the stock when the price dips to 1200; stop-loss at 1180.	

₹2694 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2666	2585	2750	2780	There is some uncertainty in intraday trend; stay out.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1441.30	27.10	19.95	8.27	
ITC	332.45	14.80	20.12	2.72	
Axis Bank	1377.00	12.45	16.18	3.35	
L&T	4325.90	11.87	31.36	4.32	
Tata Steel	209.03	10.79	28.61	1.47	
M&M	3530.50	8.09	25.97	2.68	
Bajaj Finance	1023.80	5.62	34.77	2.31	
HDFC Life	729.60	5.61	83.15	0.67	
State Bank	1218.90	5.01	13.00	4.30	
Bajaj Auto	9980.00	3.73	31.37	0.94	
Kotak Bank	426.35	3.06	22.56	2.66	
TataConsumerProduct	1169.70	3.03	78.66	0.65	
Hindalco	899.25	2.90	12.57	1.11	
Grasim Ind	2933.80	2.80	21.08	0.95	
NestleIndia	1300.90	2.45	76.91	0.79	
Hind Unilever	2323.50	2.18	54.29	1.75	
Bajaj Finserv	2060.60	2.03	17.15	1.00	
SBI Life	2059.60	1.98	84.19	0.79	
UltraTech Cement	13052.00	1.77	50.19	1.31	
Sun Pharma	1724.40	1.70	37.77	1.55	
Max Healthcare	1086.25	1.65	74.46	0.69	
JSW Steel	1251.20	1.39	39.40	1.00	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	264.10	1.29	104.55	0.74	
ICICI Bank	1408.20	1.10	17.79	8.54	
Titan	4248.60	1.10	79.14	1.49	
Apollo Hosp	7647.50	1.04	58.93	0.67	
Bharti Airtel	2021.80	0.92	31.12	0.97	
Trent Ltd.	418.72	0.74	91.89	0.79	
Cipla	1349.80	0.73	24.05	0.65	
Bharat Elec	447.70	0.67	54.88	1.36	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1076.20	0.37	22.14	1.28	
Kwallity Walls	29.33	0.27	0.00	0.02	
IntClobsecuri	4980.40	0.17	59.97	0.96	
NTPC	368.40	0.00	14.39	1.48	
Tata Motors PV	382.85	0.00	52.06	0.68	
PowerGrid Corp	300.55	-0.20	18.01	1.16	
Maruti Suzuki	15164.00	-0.43	31.93	1.69	
Asian Paints	2432.10	-0.53	59.66	0.93	
Dr Reddys Lab	1280.30	-0.60	39.35	0.66	
Eicher Motors	8009.50	-0.77	41.01	0.94	
Coal India	418.00	-1.77	8.66	0.81	
Adani Enter	2211.20	-1.81	18.06	0.49	
Wipro	211.95	-2.34	16.67	0.51	
Adani Ports	223.80	-2.51	28.50	0.97	
Tech Mahindra	1504.80	-2.65	32.11	0.81	
HDFC Bank	924.70	-3.36	18.37	12.02	
HCL Tech	1467.20	-3.56	24.17	1.32	
TCS	2694.90	-5.04	20.33	2.34	
ONGC	264.60	-6.18	7.40	0.87	
Eternal Ltd.	277.35	-6.54	115.67	3.89	
Infosys	1373.70	-13.45	19.89	4.09	

Nifty Next 50 Movers					
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Vedanta	678.00	49.88	16.00	4.91	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	710.55	41.30	100.86	2.08	
Divis Lab	6283.50	36.60	67.29	3.41	
Punjab Natl Bank	128.17	34.66	8.24	1.89	
Bpcl	380.90	34.60	6.71	3.15	
Indian Oilcorp	178.74	32.85	6.85	2.85	
Canara Bank	151.94	28.63	7.48	2.19	
Bajaj Holdings	11413.00	25.46	14.17	2.11	
Varun Beverages	46.65	22.99	51.21	2.71	
ICICI Lombard Gic	1959.70	22.88	34.85	2.02	
Rural Elec	364.30	21.36	5.56	1.94	
Indian Hotels Co.	695.10	19.37	45.71	2.60	
Samvardmotheresoninternat	1231.80	16.79	38.84	2.54	
Hyundai Motor India	2227.60	15.57	31.26	1.35	
Power Finance	420.45	15.29	4.16	2.61	
Gail (India)	167.31	12.62	12.78	1.93	
Jindal Steel	1221.80	12.11	61.82	1.95	
Britannia Ind	6176.00	10.79	61.56	3.11	
Shree Cement	26635.00	10.63	53.50	1.52	
Macrotech Cement	305.15	10.58	80.7	2.41	
Microtech Developers	1108.15	9.45	33.08	1.33	
Bosch	3569.00	8.46	38.19	1.32	
Solar Industries	13380.00	8.33	79.30	1.39	
Ibb India	5881.50	7.16	0.00	1.32	
Capgemini	642.45	6.54	35.91	1.76	
Tata Power	379.60	6.05	45.28	2.72	
Energy Solutions	1035.70	5.72	52.19	1.53	
Venusuper	3915.20	5.43	88.95	2.46	
Hindus Cnc	585.25	5.00	20.95	1.08	
Trivis Motor Cmp	3885.20	5.21	60.45	3.89	
Mazagon Dock	2386.60	4.74	48.03	0.77	
(Indo) Consumer	1217.60	3.38	68.64	2.99	
Rel	878.70	3.06	10.87	0.83	
Hydustalsciences	910.05	2.55	18.22	0.97	
Induslanc	4251.10	1.99	31.96	3.44	
Ammbuja Cements	5230.00	1.83	26.27	1.36	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	119.15	1.72	29.83	0.66	
United Spirits	144.40	1.66	24.66	2.43	
United Spirits	1424.60	0.53	60.24	1.79	
Energy India	3817.90	0.40	71.60	2.20	
Energy India	2795.50	0.34	84.36	1.06	
Havells	13434.80	0.30	60.69	1.54	
Bajaj Housing Finance	117.00	0.06	29.26	0.30	
Low Energy	486.25	-1.77	32.64	1.11	
Inditrend	1489.50	-5.59	65.51	1.97	
Info Edge I	1119.30	-12.12	43.07	1.86	
Forterra Pharma	421.00	-14.94	62.73	1.88	
Indusgreenenergy	100.10	-15.36	88.76	3.21	
Induspharma&PharmFin	171.00	-19.16	21.35	0.30	
Limindredr	5054.00	-30.74	71.76	2.00	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Bharat Forge, VVDN Tech in strategic tie-up



Pune: Bharat Forge and VVDN Technologies have signed a memorandum of understanding to explore a strategic collaboration across automotive, defence and data centre technology domains, the companies said on Wednesday. The companies aim to jointly pursue opportunities in next-generation technologies. **OUR BUREAU**

Muthoot MCred profit nearly doubles in Q3

Kochi: Muthoottu Mini Financiers, which rebranded as Muthoot MCred, has posted a net profit of ₹52.16 crore in Q3FY26 compared with ₹27.18 crore in the year-ago quarter. Its Assets Under Management stood at ₹5,494.58 crore as of Q3FY26. It reported total income from operations of ₹294.83 crore (₹203.52 crore). **OUR BUREAU**

‘We aim to double loan, deposit book in 3.5 yrs’

THRUST AREA. DCB Bank to continue focus on growing secured loans, according to MD and CEO Praveen Kutty

bl.interview

Piyush Shukla
Mumbai

Private sector lender DCB Bank is aiming to double its loan and deposit book over the next 3-3.5 years, according to MD and CEO Praveen Kutty. He says the bank, which will continue to focus on growing secured loans, aims to lower cost of deposit and expects slippages to remain stable, going ahead. *Edited excerpts:*

How is business growth panning out so far in Q4 and your business guidance for the next fiscal?

As a bank, we are focused on the self-employed segment. Majority of our deposits and loans come from this segment of customers. We are present practically across India, except the North-East. There is not a single State where we have over 20 per cent of the assets, so it is a well-diversified geographical portfolio. We have multiple

products for the self-employed segment including home loans, business loans and working capital loans for small and medium enterprises. Practically all loans, except for corporate loans, are curated for the self-employed segments. While some are agriculture-based self-employed, some are SME manufacturers, retailers, wholesalers, self-employed professionals like plumbers, welders, bakers etc. We also ensure that our loan book is, for the most part, secured and pre-dominantly we have the collateral security of residential or commercial property, and we also have a sizeable gold loan-book which, of course, is also secured. The ticket size is also low, our ₹3-crore-plus loans form only 14 per cent of advances. We see growth continuing, coming in from mortgages, gold prices are climbing and there is increased demand for gold loan. There is some bit of work that needs to be done on overdraft accounts for the SME segment. The micro-finance loans

Slippages have come down to a three-year low, GNPA and NNPA are at three-year-plus low and upgrades, as a percentage of fresh slippages, have risen to 86 per cent

PRAVEEN KUTTY
MD and CEO, DCB Bank

are lower than last year because of the recent headwinds. KCC, tractor book will continue growing in a similar range, but core mix will largely remain in favour of secured small-ticket business loans. We have grown 19 per cent in assets and 20 per cent on liabilities; we intend to double our book in 3-3.5 years. What are you doing to improve CASA ratio? Our CASA ratio stands at upwards of 22 per cent. We are



concentrating on lowering our cost of deposits and to this end CASA plays an important role. Our savings account rates are as low as 1.5 per cent, on the one hand, and also as high as high as 6.9 per cent on the other. High-cost savings account deposits is frankly the money which is coming for investments, which would otherwise have gone to bulk deposit. It improves the CASA ratio, but not the cost of deposit. So, our focus is to get cus-

tomers to use the savings account — to chase the flow and sooner than later, the float will materialise. Earlier, CASA ratio was really important because 4 per cent was the maximum return on savings accounts, but now because of the freedom to price them differently, it has become expensive. So, CASA ratio, in isolation, may not show the right picture, but the trend line of cost of deposit matters. But still, CASA remains a cheaper source of funds than term-bulk deposits. Right now, we have streamlined term deposit rates lower, and we have grown deposits by 19.5 per cent, reduced cost of deposits by 10 bps to 6.86 per cent and kept the granularity of the deposit franchise. Our top 10 depositors now account for 6.61 per cent of overall deposits, lower than past. Do you have scope to cut deposit rate further? We constantly compare the peak retail term deposit rate of our bank with top three private and top three public sector banks and we are seeing a convergence happening. The gap between us and them used to be 89 bps in March, now it has come down to 60-65 bps. The endeavour is to close this gap even further in the near future. Your guidance on credit cost.. Our goal is to maintain credit cost in the 45-55 bps range. What we are seeing is that slippages have come down to a three-year low, GNPA and NNPA are at three-year plus low and upgrades, as a percentage of fresh slippages, have risen to 86 per cent. Post-Covid, we have not seen such level of upgrades. What happens in the self-employed market is that there could be delays, but what is also very true is the resilience of customer base, which ensures that loss rates are low. How do you see NIM moving ahead? The full impact of 25-bps repo cut has not been fully baked in during Q3, some of it will come in Q4. But I think NIM will continue to improve, going ahead.

Stable Money raises \$25 m in pre-Series round

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Bengaluru-based digital fixed-return investment platform Stable Money has raised \$25 million in a Pre-Series C funding round, led by Peak XV Partners, with participation from Z47, RTP Global and Fundamentum Partnership. The company said it will use the funds to strengthen its platform, expand savings products and hire across product, partnerships and technology. It said fixed deposits (FDs) remain a large savings category in India, with over 230 million people relying on them. It said the segment is growing at nearly 12 per cent annually. Stable Money said users can book FDs without opening a savings account and access instant withdrawals. The company plans to expand partnerships with banks and NBFCs to widen customer choice and improve rate discovery. It also plans to expand beyond digital channels and build an on-ground presence in key cities. With inputs from intern Tejaswini S

Investors see potential in climate finance in India amid global energy transition

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Global investors, development finance institutions and commercial banks signalled an unprecedented scaling up of climate finance for India, positioning the country as a central pillar in the global energy transition. At the Mumbai Climate Week, speakers underscored the trillions of dollars required annually to meet net-zero goals. HSBC estimated that the global transition economy needs about \$5 trillion a year — nearly double the current investment levels — with additional demand emerging from energy-intensive sectors such as AI-driven data centres. With structured risk mitigation and scalable models, investors increasingly see India's green transition as both an environmental necessity and a multi-trillion-dollar commercial opportunity.

INDIA MARKET
The International Finance Corporation (IFC) said it has quadrupled its annual financing in India in recent years and aims to scale up to \$10 billion annually by 2030.



SHIFTING PERCEPTION. With structured risk mitigation and scalable models, investors increasingly see India's green transition as both an environmental necessity and a multi-trillion-dollar commercial opportunity. GETTY IMAGES

“We are actually shifting to respond to the challenge, making sure that in a middle-income country like India, the World Bank group moves from a financing institution to a leveraging bank, where we are going to be, hopefully by 2030, deploying \$8-10 billion annually from our own resources and leveraging close to \$20 billion in private capital in support of the priorities of India,” said Imad Pakhoury, Regional Director, South Asia, IFC. British International Investment's Head of Climate, Amal-Lee Amin, highlighted its catalytic equity invest-

ments in renewable platforms, noting that relatively modest equity infusions have mobilised billions in additional capital. “We have learned a lot here in India. And we're now looking to build on that. As we look ahead into our new strategy period, mobilisation is going to be a core pillar, particularly here in India, in South-East Asia,” she said. Meanwhile, Lawrence Yanovitch, Founder & CEO, One Planet Sovereign Wealth Funds, stressed that sovereign wealth funds are increasingly aligning long-term portfolios with Paris

Agreement goals and sees India as an attractive, scalable market. Innovations such as pay-per-use electric vehicle battery financing and programmatic renewable platforms are expanding market depth, said V Vaideyanathan, CEO, IDFC First Bank, which has a ₹6,000-crore exposure to the segment. India's climate action plan targets a 45 per cent reduction in emissions intensity by 2030, with a goal to achieve net-zero goal by 2070. It is also aiming to reach 500-GW power generation through non-fossil fuels by 2030.

Dr Reddy's enters hormone replacement therapy biz

Our Bureau
Hyderabad



Dr Reddy's Laboratories has acquired the trademarks of specialty brands, Progynova and Cyclo-Progynova, and related assets, for India from Mercury Pharma Group, a UK-headquartered specialty pharmaceutical company for \$32.15 million. Progynova (estradiol valerate) is an oral hormone replacement therapy (HRT) indicated for the treatment of estrogen deficiency symptoms and for the prevention

of post-menopausal osteoporosis. Cyclo-Progynova (estradiol valerate and norgestrel) is a combined HRT indicated for the treatment of estrogen deficiency symptoms, providing both estrogen and progestogen components. Progynova is the ‘number

one' brand in the Estradiol represented pharmaceutical market (RPM), with strong physician equity and brand recall in India. **STRATEGIC ENTRY** As per IQVIA December 2025 data, the brand recorded sales of ₹100 crore. The acquisition strengthens Hyderabad-based Dr Reddy's gynaecology portfolio and marks a strategic entry into the HRT segment. “The acquisition will serve as the spearhead of our expansion into the HRT segment, strengthening our ex-

isting gynaecology portfolio in India,” MV Ramana, Chief Executive Officer-Branded Markets (India and Emerging Markets), Dr Reddy's, said in a release. “With our established market access, we are uniquely positioned to extend the reach of the acquired assets and deliver greater impact. Furthermore, this acquisition brings a first-in-class treatment closer to patients, underscoring our commitment to innovation and patient care at the centre of everything we do,” Ramana added.

HUL tops Hurun India Impact 50 list

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Over ₹8,000 crore was spent on corporate social responsibility activities by the country's top 50 companies last year. According to the Perpetual Capital Hurun India Impact 50 – 2026, the activities reached more than 200 million beneficiaries nationwide. Hindustan Unilever (HUL) tops the list with 53.9 points, showcasing balanced performance across SDGs (sustainable development goals), including climate, water, circularity, gender and life on land. HCL Technologies ranks second, with 53.8 points, employing 67,217 women, the highest female workforce in India's technology sector, with major reductions in operational emissions and expansion of energy-efficient digital solutions. Grasim Industries (52.6 points), Tata Motors (51.8 points) and Dabur India (50.3 points) round out the top five. Climate Action (SDG 13) ranks first among the prior-

ities, with 48 companies setting time-bound targets, followed by Responsible Consumption & Production (40 companies) and Affordable & Clean Energy (30 companies). The 50 companies in the list generated a combined revenue of ₹48.5 lakh crore. **METHODOLOGY** The ranking is based on companies that work on SDGs, using publicly available information. “Three years ago, when we launched this list, that shift was still aspirational. Today, it is measurable. HUL runs on 97 per cent renewable energy. JSW Energy reuses 102 per cent of its waste. Mahindra & Mahindra is 15 times water-positive. These are fundamental reimaginings of how Indian industry operates,” Anas Rahman Junaid, Founder and Chief Researcher, Hurun India, said. “The list reflects that the impact is no longer just a founding principle for early-stage ventures, but it is a core business imperative for India's largest corporations,” Pranav Prashanth, Partner, Perpetual Capital, said.

MALABAR CEMENTS LIMITED (A Government of Kerala Undertaking) An ISO 9001:2015, 14001:2015 Company, Walaray Post, Palakkad - 678624 - Kerala Email: bulkmcl@malabarceements.com / material@malabarceements.com									
TENDER NOTICE									
Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in for Online Submission of Bids for:									
❖ Engagement of JCB/Backhoe loader for material handling operation in CGU, Pallipuram, Cherthala.									
❖ Sale of 15,000 MT crushed overburden at plant of Malabar Cements Limited, Walaray. ❖ Design and engineering, manufacture and supply, installation, erection and commissioning of concrete paving blocks/concrete solid blocks manufacturing unit at MCL, Walaray plant including civil and structural works on turnkey basis. ❖ Supply of 5,000 MT Clinker ON FOR Cement Grinding Unit, Pallipuram, Cherthala, Alappuzha District, Kerala. ❖ Supply of 5,000 MT Clinker ON FOR Walaray basis. ❖ Loading of Packed Cement into Railway wagons. ❖ Collection and transportation of cement within 350km radius from Malabar Cements Limited, Walaray to various locations in Kerala and Tamil Nadu through bulker. ❖ Collection and transportation of 5,000 MT dry fly ash from Neyveli Lignite Corporation India Limited (NLC) Neyveli, Cuddalore District, Tamil Nadu state to Malabar Cements Limited, Walaray, Palakkad/Cement Grinding Unit, Pallipuram, Cherthala. ❖ Supply of Industrial Fuel. ❖ Supply of Explosives. Visit www.mstcecommerce.com for the following E-Auctions: ❖ E-Auction for Disposal of Old 13 Motor Cycles and Disposal of two Tipper at MCL, Walaray through ELV Scrapping Portal of MSTC. ❖ E-Auction for Disposal of Copper Scrap Items (Starter, Alternator & Condenser) at MCL Mines, Walaray. ❖ Disposal of MS/CS Mixed Solid Scrap Items at MCL, Walaray. ❖ E-Auction for Disposal of Ropeway Rope (High Carbon Steel) Scrap Materials at MCL, Walaray. Visit www.malabarceements.co.in for the following tender: ❖ Disposal of Used Forklift at MCL, Walaray.									
Sd/-, MANAGING DIRECTOR									

VENLON ENTERPRISES LIMITED POLYAL Regd. Office & Works : 28 (P) & Plot No 2, Belavadi Industrial Area, Hunsur Road, Mysuru - 570 018 Phone : (0821) 2402530 e-mail: convention@venlon.com CIN : L24231KA1983PLC015089									
STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 31ST DECEMBER 2025									
(Rs. in Lakhs)									
Particulars	Quarter Ended		Nine Months Ended		Financial Year Ended				
	31-12-2025	30-09-2025	31-12-2024	31-12-2025	31-12-2024	31-12-2025	31-12-2025	31-12-2025	31-12-2025
Total Income	137.37	271.32	315.71	576.48	880.98	1,195.75			
Net Profit for the period (before tax exceptional and /or extraordinary item)	(69.54)	(45.93)	(44.44)	(214.82)	(146.32)	(1,317.97)			
Net Profit for the period before tax (after exceptional and /or extraordinary item)	(69.54)	(45.93)	(44.44)	(214.82)	(146.32)	(1,317.97)			
Net Profit for the period after tax (after exceptional and /or extraordinary item)	(69.54)	(45.93)	(44.44)	(214.82)	(146.32)	(1,317.97)			
Equity Share Capital	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12			
Reserve and Surplus	-	-	-	-	-	(1863.24)			
Earnings Per Share (of ₹/- each)									
Basic:	(0.13)	(0.09)	(0.09)	(0.41)	(0.28)	(2.52)			
Diluted:	(0.13)	(0.09)	(0.09)	(0.41)	(0.28)	(2.52)			
The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of Quarterly Financial Results are available on the website of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com & Company's website https://venlonenterprises.co.in/ and can be accessed by using the QR Code provided below.									
Place : Mysore Date : 14.02.2026				By Order of the Board C D Datwani (DIN:00355181) Chairman & Managing Director					

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QUICKLY.

Gold rises as investors weigh geopolitical risks



Gold rose more than 1 per cent on Wednesday as investors assessed simmering geopolitical risks, while the markets also awaited the US Federal Reserve's January meeting minutes due later in the day. Spot gold was up 1.7 per cent at \$4,957.70 per ounce by 9.15 am ET (1415 GMT). US gold futures for April delivery gained 0.5 per cent to \$4,977.80. REUTERS

Copper climbs on dip-buying in thin trade

London: Copper prices moved higher on Wednesday, rebounding from more than a one-week low in the previous session, as investors stepped in to buy the dip amid thin trade volumes. Benchmark copper on the LME was up 0.6 per cent at \$12,700 a metric tonne in official open outcry activity, after climbing as much as 1.2 per cent earlier in the session. REUTERS

Crude oil edges higher on progress in US-Iran talks



London: Crude oil prices edged higher on Wednesday after falling about 2 per cent in the previous session as investors assessed progress in US-Iran talks but remained cautious about the prospects of a final deal that could ease supply concerns. Brent crude oil futures rose 26 cents to \$67.68 a barrel by 0931 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate crude was up 24 cents at \$62.57, though both remained around two-week lows. REUTERS

Exporters face uphill task to ship wheat

LACKING PARITY. With MSP hiked to ₹2,585 a quintal this year, the grain will be \$45/t higher than global rates

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

India will find it tough to get buyers abroad for its wheat as the domestic cost of the foodgrain is higher than in the global market, traders and analysts say.

According to a New Delhi-based trader, it will be an uphill task, particularly with the government fixing the minimum support price for wheat at ₹2,585 a quintal, up ₹160 from last year.

Last week, the government lifted a nearly four-year-old ban on wheat exports and allowed shipments of 2.5 million tonnes (mt). This was to ensure remunerative prices for growers after domestic rates dropped to ₹2,527/quintal in the first half of this month from ₹2,587 in January.

CURRENT PRICES

Currently, domestic wheat delivered at Kandla port from Rajasthan, Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh costs between ₹25,200 and ₹2,5500 a tonne. In dollar terms, wheat delivered at Kandla is pegged at \$285-288

Wheat cost & freight price (₹/q)		
Origins	West coast (Kandla)	East coast (Vizag)
Gujarat	308	-
Rajasthan	305	-
Uttar Pradesh	306	311
Madhya Pradesh	308	306
Disparity	45-48	46-51

a tonne. If a freight rate of \$20 a tonne is taken into account for the Middle East and South-East Asia, the cost and freight could be \$305-308 a tonne.

At the same time, if Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh wheat is to be shipped from Visakhapatnam, it could cost \$306-310 a tonne.

In comparison, global wheat prices are ruling at \$260 a tonne. “Though Indian wheat commands some premium in the Middle East, a difference of \$45-48 will make it pricey,” said the trader.

GLOBAL OFFERS

Another North India-based trader said Indian wheat will not be able to compete internationally as farmers are unlikely to offer wheat below the MSP.



Traders said global trading companies, such as Olam International, Bunge and Louis Dreyfus, were offering wheat for the second half of March between \$286 and \$290 a tonne.

Another trader, based in the South, said Indian wheat prices with 11.5 protein content are traded \$20 a tonne higher than the grain from the Black Sea region.

According to Freyer's wheat report, Australian wheat is finding good demand in the global market despite stiff competition from Argentina and a strong Australian dollar.

North American wheat is finding export demand, which could be higher than what the US Department of Agriculture has forecast, while the produce from the European Union and the

Black Sea region is getting sidelined.

According to the Australian Bureau of Statistics, Australia's wheat exports more than doubled to 2.29 mt in December from November 2025, with Indonesia, China and the Philippines being the major bulk buyers.

However, there is one option for India to export wheat. It can be by road or rail to Bangladesh. The South-based trader said wheat exported from Bihar by road or rail could cost \$283 a tonne compared with the current landing price of \$270. “Wheat export to Bangladesh is the best option. The best-case scenario is India can export a maximum of one lakh tonnes, that too from Bihar,” said the trader.

Traders said that with a new regime taking over in Bangladesh under Tariq Rahman, India could look at government-to-government export of wheat.

RECORD STOCKS

An analyst said India is under pressure to export wheat as its ending stocks as of March

31 could be at a 10-year high of 21 mt. Currently, the Food Corporation of India (FCI) has 25.31 mt of wheat and 34.61 mt of record-high rice stocks. It also has unmilled paddy, which in terms of rice is 40.49 mt.

“With the upcoming wheat crop looking good and no chance of the government providing subsidy for exports, one wonders how India will compete in the export market,” wondered the North-based trader.

India banned wheat exports on May 13, 2022, after the production was affected by severe heatwaves in the growing regions. The ban was also to tame rising food inflation as wheat prices surged 60 per cent then. The production that year was pegged at below 110 million tonnes.

In 2023, too, production was affected by unseasonal rain, though it improved to 113.29 million tonnes. Following the climate change impact, the government encouraged farmers to go in for climate-resilient wheat varieties from the 2024 season. This helped production to increase to 117.95 million tonnes in 2025.

VST Tillers Tractors to revive its US plans

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Farm equipment maker VST Tillers Tractors Ltd is reviving its plans for entry into the US market, following the recent India-US trade deal.

The company, which is eyeing the compact tractor segment in the US, had frozen its plans last year following the levy of tariffs by the Trump administration.

“We will be launching our US operations by the end of 2027,” said Antony Cherukara, CEO, VST Tillers Tractors.

VST had registered a company in the US a couple of years ago, but had frozen the plans after the tariffs were imposed. “With 50 per cent tariffs, we couldn't operate. Now with the revision in tariffs, we have again started the plans. Our original plan was to launch a compact tractor in the US in 2027. We should be able to do that by end of the of 2027,” he said.

The company is looking at a compact tractor in the range of 30-50 horse power for the US market. “There are key specific States in the US, which are focused on compact tractors and the industry is pretty large in the US compared to India. So, that is where we are planning to enter,” he said.

The company is in the process of developing a global platform for the US market. “The development is happening in India and then we will be looking at exporting to the US and selling in the US. Eventually, depending on the conditions and the policies, we might have to look at something in the US as well,” he said.

HUGE MARKET

Antony said the interest for the compact tractor is mainly coming from hobby farmers, orchards and vineyards in parts of California and other States. It's for mixed-use, and they call it garden tractors. This four-wheel drive compact size market in India is only about



Antony Cherukara, CEO, VST Tillers Tractors Ltd

50,000-60,000 tractors annually, while in the US it is upwards of 2,00,000 tractors, he added.

Also, the company is planning to set up a warehousing and distribution hub in Europe, most likely in the Netherlands, to cater to the growing demand for compact tractors in the continent. The warehousing hub is expected to come up in the first quarter of the next financial year.

VST exports compact tractors mainly to the European market. The company has seen its export earnings grow significantly to account for about 13 per cent of the total revenues currently, from around 4 per cent four years ago. “In the next five years, we want to increase our export earnings to about 25 per cent of the company's revenues,” he said.

VST is optimistic about the impact of the recent trade deal with the European Union. “The taxes on Indian tractors weren't high earlier. We are studying. It should help us set up operations in Europe,” he said.

With the setting up of European operations, the company expects to double its business in the region in the next four years, he said.

In Europe also, the use case is similar — garden tractors, hobby tractors, vineyards, orchards and horse stables.

The company is planning to launch the internal combustion engines (ICE) tractors in Europe and the US. “We are also ready with electric tractors. In fact, we have the technology,” he said.

Corteva, BASF introduce non-GM herbicide-tolerant mustard tech

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Corteva India, in strategic partnership with BASF India, has unveiled a Clearfield Production System for the mustard crop. This innovative, non-GM crop system is herbicide-tolerant and aims to improve cultivation through better weed control and higher yield potential.

With an output exceeding 4 mt, mustard plays a pivotal role as the largest contributor among edible oil-yielding crops. Indian farmers cultivate over 8 million hectares each year and face major challenges from parasitic weeds like Orabanche, which can cause yield losses of up to 50 per cent.

The Clearfield technology, including the Kifix herbicide,



is a proprietary innovation of BASF, known for delivering broad-spectrum and selective control against difficult weeds such as Orabanche.

The system integrates Corteva's advanced and high-yielding genetics, with BASF Clearfield Herbicide-tolerant trait. The mustard seeds developed with the Clearfield trait are non-transgenic and non-genetically modified, achieved through conventional plant-breeding techniques. These seeds will be sold exclusively

under the Pioneer brand by Corteva.

FARMERS WELCOME

Rajasthan Agriculture and Horticulture Minister Kirodi Lal Meena said, “Rajasthan is a vital mustard production hub in India. Our farmers face immense pressure from pests and weeds like Orabanche. The Clearfield Mustard Production System from Corteva and BASF is a welcome innovation. It promises relief and prosperity for our mustard growers, enhancing agricultural productivity, ensuring stable output and safeguarding farmer livelihoods.”

“BASF is delighted to launch Clearfield Production System for our mustard farmers in India,” said Giridhar Ranuva, Director, BASF Agricultural Solutions India.

Copper: Go short at ₹1,170, stop-loss at ₹1,185

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl.research bureau

Copper futures are now trading at ₹1,165 (per kg). The contract has been on a decline since the beginning of the month. Extending the decline, it slipped below the support at ₹1,200 last week.

COMMODITY CALL.

On Tuesday, it lost nearly 4 per cent and closed below another support at ₹1,180, indicating good downward momentum.

The recent price action shows a bearish bias. That said, for the near term, the downsling may not extend much as there is support ahead at ₹1,135, the 50 per cent Fibonacci retracement



of the prior uptrend. Subsequent support is at ₹1,080. Overall, we expect copper to inch up to the ₹1,175-1,180 price band and then see another leg of fall to ₹1,135. This opens up a short-term trading opportunity.

TRADE STRATEGY

Short copper at ₹1,170. Place stop-loss at ₹1,185. When the contract slips to ₹1,150, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,170. Book profits at ₹1,135.

Higher area under summer crops may offset lower kharif pulses output

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Higher area under groundnut, maize has helped the area under summer (*Zaid*) sowing to take an early lead over the year-ago period. Initial data show that the area under pulses is a tad higher, but paddy acreage is marginally lower from last year.

Sowing of summer crops, which will end by May, has reached 15.18 lakh hectares (lh) as of February 13, which is 3 per cent more than 14.75 lh reported in the year-ago period. The *Zaid* season sowing is progressing well, the government said, as reservoir levels are up 10 per cent compared with last year.

The area under summer crop was earlier included under kharif or rabi season, but



a few years ago, government decided to start collating the data separately. The last five year's average coverage under summer crops is 75.37 lh, whereas the area reached a record high of 83.92 lh in 2024-25. The share of summer crops was 19.11 million tonnes (mt) or 5.3 per cent in the total foodgrains production of 357.73 mt in 2024-25.

MOONG COVERAGE

As per the weekly update released by the Agriculture Ministry, paddy sowing was

down 2.7 per cent at 12.80 lh from 13.16 lh, while nutri/coarse cereals area was up at 82,000 hectares against 50,000 hectares a year ago. Among the nutri/coarse cereals, the maize area is up at 0.63 lh from 0.48 lh, while jowar has reached 0.03 lh, ragi at 0.09 lh and bajra at 0.06 lh until February 13.

Area under summer pulses reached 0.58 lh from 0.50 lh, in which coverage of green gram (moong) reached at 0.44 lh, and blackgram (urad) at 0.10 lh. The key growers of summer pulses are Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Odisha, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat. Summer pulses are key to offset when there is a fall in kharif crops. In 2025-26 kharif pulses production has been estimated at 7.41 mt from 7.73 mt in 2024-25.

Alliance Bioversity, CIAT promote native crops

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Rome-based Alliance Bioversity and CIAT (International Center for Tropical Agriculture) are promoting the cultivation and conservation of 20-25 native varieties of Indian crops as part of efforts to save genetic resources, according to Dr Jai Singh Rana, Country Director for Bioversity in Asia.

“We are promoting native varieties in over 3 lakh hectares. We are working in 15 States. We give these native genetic resources to the market and help people cultivate them,” Rana told *businessline*.

GLOBAL PRESENCE

Not-for-profit Alliance Bioversity and CIAT came together in 2019 to tackle climate change, biodiversity



Jai Singh Rana, Country Director for Bioversity in Asia

loss, environmental degradation and malnutrition.

The alliance is present in over 100 countries, including in Asia, Africa, Latin America and Europe. Alliance Bioversity has been present in India for over 40 years now.

“In India, our work has been towards value addition, branding and licensing for breaking native breeds, apart from the cultivation and

conservation of native breeds,” he said.

The consortium is tapping into the nearly private gene banks, most of them family-owned. It also profiles these varieties for nutritional properties, besides taste.

The Rome-based organisation is promoting native varieties of bananas, rice, beans, cassava (tapioca) and legumes.

TN RICE PROJECT

“India is a diverse country, rich in biodiversity and genetic resources. We have collaborations with the Government of India and organisations such as the Indian Council of Agricultural Research,” said Rana.

In Asia, the consortium is working in Nepal, Bangladesh, China, Uzbekistan, Vietnam, Malaysia, Indonesia, the Philippines and Laos, among other nations.

It spends almost ₹10 crore annually in India. Its work in Africa is also similar, where it promotes breeding of banana, beans and cassava.

“In Tamil Nadu, we are working with the Green Cause Foundation to promote native rice varieties over the past 7-8 years. We plan to expand our activities to local varieties of other crops too in the State,” he said.

In Tamil Nadu, the alliance's support has seen the Green Cause Foundation setting up three seed banks of native rice varieties. It now supports similar seed banks in other parts of the State.

The alliance is backing similar projects in States such as Maharashtra, Karnataka, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Rajasthan and Odisha, among others, said Rana.

Western disturbances wallop North, Central India

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

An unusually active western disturbance combining with a peer disturbance to the north of the country and a non-seasonal low-pressure area to the east of Sri Lanka hovering over south-west Bay of Bengal are currently dictating wet and variously violent weather to the hills and plains of North-West India and South Peninsula.

An incoming western disturbance over south-east Pakistan and west Rajasthan have merged with a peer disturbance over central Pakistan and adjoining Punjab, setting the stage for disturbed weather over North-West and Central India. In the melee, an induced cyclonic circulation popped up over south-west Rajasthan.

All of them are weather-makers individually and col-



SPELLBOUND. Isolated rain, thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds are likely over the Andaman and Nicobar Islands as the 'low' in the Bay pushes moist easterlies into the islands

lectively. In addition, moisture fanned by the western disturbance combo with its underbelly sweeping the Arabian Sea triggered the formation of another stray circulation over north-east Madhya Pradesh, amplifying weather over Central India.

An overarching trough of lower pressure lay extended from east-central Arabian Sea to central Madhya Pradesh across Gujarat and

south-east Rajasthan, setting up the larger context of the late-winter weather.

RAIN, SNOW FORECAST

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) predicted continued isolated rain/snow for Uttarakhand on Thursday.

Isolated rain, thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds are likely over the Andaman and Nicobar Islands

as the 'low' in the Bay pushes moist easterlies into the islands. These are expected to spill over into Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe for three days from Friday.

The 'low' persisting over the Equatorial Indian Ocean and the adjoining south-west Bay of Bengal (towards the east of Sri Lanka) is likely to move west-northwestwards towards Sri Lanka and become more marked (intensify a round) over the south-west Bay of Bengal and the adjoining Equatorial Indian Ocean by Thursday.

The 24 hours ending at 8.30 am on Wednesday brought rain at a few places over Haryana-Chandigarh-Delhi and at isolated places over the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, the hills of West Bengal and Sikkim, Punjab, west Rajasthan, east Rajasthan, west Madhya Pradesh, and Kerala and Mahe.

QUICKLY.

EV charging: chargeMOD, Mercedes-Benz tie up

Kochi: chargeMOD has collaborated with Mercedes-Benz India to integrate its expansive network of over 500 charging points directly into the MB. CHARGE Public digital ecosystem for Mercedes-Benz owners. Mercedes-Benz India customers can now enjoy a smarter way to charge as the chargeMOD network is now natively connected to the Mercedes-Benz digital ecosystem. OUR BUREAU

NHAI imposes tender ban on NCC for 2 years

Hyderabad: NCC Ltd, along with OB Infrastructure, a step-down subsidiary, has received an order of debarment from the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI). As per the order the entities have been debarred from participating in any tender/bids issued by the NHAI for a period of two years with effect from February 17. NCC's scrip declined 1.77 per cent to end at ₹149.45 on Wednesday. OUR BUREAU

Gujarat presents ₹4.08 lakh crore surplus Budget, up 10% over FY26

PITCH PERFECT. State earmarks ₹1,278 crore for sports infra with eyes on Commonwealth Games 2030

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The Gujarat government on Wednesday unveiled a ₹4.08 lakh crore surplus Budget for FY27, marking a 10.2 per cent increase over FY26, with a thrust on industrial expansion across mining, semiconductors and advanced manufacturing. The State is also hoping to host the Olympic games and has earmarked significant funds for related infrastructure.

The Budget projects a surplus of ₹974 crore for 2026-27.

OLYMPIC-READY CITY

It also highlighted steps towards hosting the 2030 Commonwealth Games and scaling up sports infrastructure.

At the heart of the spending plan for FY27, is Ahmedabad's pitch to become an "Olympic-ready



POSITIVE STEP. Gujarat Finance Minister Kanu Desai before the presentation of Budget in Gandhinagar on Wednesday

City" ahead of the 2030 Commonwealth Games. The government has earmarked ₹1,278 crore to develop international-standard sports complexes and stadiums, upgrade public transport and position Ahmedabad as an "Olympic-ready City" for hosting the 2030 Common-

wealth Games. This includes ₹500 crore for development of the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Sports Enclave and related infrastructure in the city and ₹90 crore for a world-class hockey stadium. In addition to these, ₹58 crore has been provided for a

The State government hopes to make Ahmedabad a Olympic-ready city with adequate infrastructure

Neuro, Ortho and Sports Injury Rehabilitation Centre in Ahmedabad.

MINING & ENERGY

It has provided ₹613 crore for the Ambaji Copper Project, which will become Gujarat's first underground copper-lead-zinc mine.

The project will be developed beneath Ambaji town by the Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation (GMDC).

The government has also allocated ₹300 crore for a lignite-based underground coal gasification project and ₹150 crore for a floating solar pro-

ject at Kadana dam.

The government has allocated ₹1,100 crore under the Gujarat Semiconductor Policy and ₹150 crore under the Gujarat Electronics Policy, and ₹50 crore for infrastructure development at the Dholera Special Investment Region.

TEXTILE UNITS

The State has also provided ₹2,755 crore to support textile units and ₹1,775 crore under Assistance to MSME-2022.

According to the document, The Gujarat Unified Digital Stack initiative will be developed with ₹100 crore to provide single-platform digital access to government services.

The government also extended by one year the rebate on e-vehicles, keeping the effective motor vehicle tax at one per cent instead of up to six per cent — to benefit citizens by ₹210 crore.

BIRAC consulting experts for measures to boost innovation

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC), Department of Biotechnology, will soon have a say in key regulatory changes relating to biotech/life sciences to promote speedy innovation, said Jitendra Kumar, Managing Director, BIRAC.

BIRAC recently conducted a meeting at the behest of the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) with top officials and also the NITI Aayog in the consultations, Kumar said at a panel discussion on innovation in India at the BioAsia 2026 here on Wednesday.

"A regulatory sandbox has also been mooted. BIRAC is trying to deal with the challenge of innovation. We need big companies for serious research," he said, adding that efforts in innovation should go hand in hand with focus on generics.

BIRAC is also ready to extend financial support to the

big players in the industry for innovative research programmes, Kumar said, while asking interested companies to approach the council with suitable proposals.

Last week, the first national call for the ₹2,000 crore BIRAC-RDI Fund was launched to scale high-impact biotechnology innovations under the Government's ₹1 lakh crore Research, Development, and Innovation (RDI) initiative. Eligible start-ups, SMEs and industry partners can submit proposals online. The deadline for Phase 1 submissions is March 31, 2026.

PROGRESS

In the last 10 years, "substantial" progress has been made in the biotech sector, he said.

"The number of biotech start-ups were below 500 in 2014; this has now gone up to over 10,000. The value of the bioeconomy component grew from \$50 billion in 2014 to \$167.5 billion now," Kumar said.

Gujarat to grow at 11.4% in FY27, GSDP pegged at ₹33.24 lakh crore

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Gujarat's economy is projected to expand 11.4 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) in FY27, taking the Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) to ₹33.24 lakh crore, according to the State Budget presented in the Assembly on Wednesday.

The rebound comes after steady growth moderation since FY22.

For the current financial year, Gujarat's GSDP at current prices is estimated to grow 10.4 per cent to ₹29.84 lakh crore.

The government, in its medium-term fiscal policy statement, presented with the State Budget, noted that the State's economy has recorded an annualised growth rate of 11.94 per cent over the past 15 years (FY12-FY26) under the 2011-12 base year series.

GAINS & LOSSES

The share of agriculture in GSDP has declined to 14.2 per cent in FY25 from 17.8 per cent in FY12, while manufacturing's contribution has risen to 32.8 per cent (28.4 per cent).

Total expenditure has grown at an annual rate of



The share of agriculture in the GSDP has declined to 14.2 per cent in FY25 from 17.8 per cent in FY12

10.82 per cent in the 15 years FY26 (Revised Estimates), lower than the GSDP growth

rate of 11.94 per cent, suggesting spending discipline relative to economic expansion.

At the same time, capital expenditure has accelerated sharply, from ₹98,106 crore in FY25 to ₹1.23 lakh crore in FY26 (RE), up 25.94 per cent y-o-y. For FY27 (BE), the government has budgeted capex of ₹1.57 lakh crore.

REVENUE & TAX

The State's taxes have expanded at a slightly lower CAGR of 9.36 per cent over FY12-FY26 (RE).

VAT/GST remains the largest contributor to the State's own tax revenue, ac-

counting for 68.53 per cent of the total in FY26 (RE). VAT/GST collections have grown at an annualised rate of 9.14 per cent between FY12 and FY26 (RE), while land revenue has registered a stronger annualised growth of 10.38 per cent during the same period.

FISCAL POSITION

The State's public debt is expected to rise to ₹4.87 lakh crore in FY27 from ₹4.3 lakh crore (RE) in FY26, marking an increase of over 13 per cent.

Central government loans have risen to 6.89 per cent in FY25 from 2.76 per cent in

FY22, largely due to borrowings under the Scheme for Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment — a 50-year interest-free loan programme.

Gujarat received ₹5,958 crore under the scheme in FY25.

Despite rising borrowings, Gujarat's debt servicing profile has improved.

The average cost of debt has declined from 8.88 per cent in FY12 to 7.26 per cent in FY25 and is expected to moderate further to 7.23 per cent in FY26 (RE).

The State has diversified its borrowing tenure between two and 12 years,

resulting in competitive rates on State Government Securities (SGS).

FISCAL DEFICIT

The government has pegged fiscal deficit for FY25 at ₹48,965 crore, or 1.81 per cent of GSDP.

For FY26 (RE), it is estimated at ₹58,052 crore (1.95 per cent of GSDP), rising to ₹65,519 crore in FY27 (1.97 per cent of GSDP).

While absolute deficit and debt levels are rising in line with economic expansion, the ratios remain below 2 per cent of GSDP, signalling continued fiscal consolidation discipline.

CAG flags loss of ₹2,354 crore due to design flaws in NLC India's thermal power stations

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG) has rapped NLC India (NL-CIL) for a loss of ₹2,354 crore due to under-recovery of capacity charges on account of design flaws in its thermal power stations (TPSs). The findings relate to lignite mines and selected TPSs at Neyveli for five years from FY18 to FY23.

MAJOR SHORTFALL

Key issues pointed out by the audit include a delay in land acquisition for mining, delay in obtaining environmental clearance, compliance of dumping of overburden norms, design deficiencies in CFBC boilers, inadequate preventive and breakdown maintenance procedures, lignite quality and non-compliance with environmental and safety regulations.

The CAG said it noticed



AUDIT TRAILS. Delays in land acquisition for mining and obtaining environmental clearance were among key issues

"significant inefficiencies" in operations, safety and environmental compliance of NL-CIL's TPS-IE (TPS I Extension), TPS-II and TPS-IIIE (TPS II Extension) for the review period.

The most significant issue was the consistent non-achievement of the required Plant Availability Factor (PAF), which caused a total loss of ₹2,353.99 crore due to under-recovery of capacity charges.

This the CAG attributed mainly to design flaws in cir-

culating fluidised bed combustion (CFBC) boilers, turbine breakdowns, forced outages, fire incidents and inadequate maintenance practices.

TECHNICAL GLITCHES

In addition to this, power stations suffered partial load loss due to issues like load restrictions, equipment breakdowns, poor quality of lignite and wet lignite due to lack of essential infrastructure like covered storage yards and conveyors, it added.

Most significant issue was the consistent non-achievement of the Plant Availability Factor, which caused a total loss of ₹2,353.99 crore

"This resulted in the loss of 1,594.77 million units (MU) of electricity and under-recovery of lignite extraction costs for mines to the extent of ₹360.52 crore," it said. Other key problems in the TPSs were high auxiliary power consumption exceeding CERC norms, particularly at TPS-IIIE.

This was caused due to absence of equipment-wise monitoring of power consumption, partial load operations and delayed implementation of energy audit recommendations.

Biennial polls to 37 RS seats on March 16, BJP-led NDA to consolidate its strength

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Election Commission of India on Wednesday announced biennial polls to 37 Rajya Sabha seats from 10 States on March 16.

The States where the seats are up for grabs are: Maharashtra (7), Odisha (4), Telangana (2), Tamil Nadu (6), Chhattisgarh (2), West Bengal (5), Assam (3), Haryana (2), Himachal Pradesh (1) and Bihar (5).

Of these, the BJP is now in power in Maharashtra, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Haryana, Assam and Bihar, which account for 23 of the 37 seats of the Upper House. This poses an opportunity for the BJP to increase its strength.

In Himachal Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and West Bengal, the Opposition parties are in power.

The BJP's representation from Maharashtra in the Rajya Sabha will increase fol-



lowing the biennial elections. If the opposition alliance Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) puts up a united fight, it can send one candidate from the seven seats falling vacant in the State, said election observers.

NDA AT THE HELM

Presently, the BJP has 102 MPs, including nominated Rajya Sabha members who joined the party.

The NDA's overall tally — having partners like the Shiv

Sena (Eknath Shinde faction), the NCP (Ajit Pawar faction) and the AGP — is at 134, which is way past the majority figure of 123 MPs needed in the 245-member Upper House.

Prominent Rajya Sabha members whose terms are coming to an end in April include former Union Minister Sharad Pawar of NCP (SP), Shiv Sena (UBT) party's Priyanka Vickram Chaturvedi, Union Minister from Republican Party of India (A) Ramdas Bandu Athawale, DMK's Dr Kanimozhi, NVN Somu and Tiruchi Siva, Congress' Abhishek Singhvi, and TMC's Saket Gokhale.

As per the schedule announced by the ECI, the poll notifications will be issued on February 26, making March 5 the last date for filing nominations.

The last date for withdrawal of candidates has been fixed for March 9. The results will be announced on March 16.

'Trade deal with US, EU to rake in growth capital'

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The free trade agreements (FTA) with the US and the EU will bring in huge growth capital, besides opening up business opportunities for both countries, assured Piyush Goyal, Union Commerce and Industry Minister.

After the EU and US trade deals are signed, India will see a flood of capital coming from there. "I also wish to see more domestic capital coming into the start-up ecosystem. Because that will keep the innovation also going forward," he said at the day-two of Global Economic Cooperation summit here on Wednesday.

The government has announced a ₹10,000 crore start-up Fund of Funds. Currently, the focus will be on



Piyush Goyal, Commerce and Industry Minister

newer ideas such as fintech, while striking a balance with health tech and hybrid tech.

"The start-up fund will also focus on deeptech, which will include AI, quantum computing and machine learning. We are hoping to use this money in early-stage funding because in deeptech, the gestation period is very long," he said. Expressing shock over the

stock market's concerns regarding the Indian IT sector, Goyal said, "I find it quite ridiculous. These are the companies that will be required for artificial intelligence."

As AI grows, hacking into systems may become vibrant. So the need for cyber security will grow manifold.

Similarly, databases tend to get corrupted with bots. "We need human beings to scrub that data. Otherwise, it is garbage. If you depend on databases without human validation, you get really bad results," he said.

HAND-IN-HAND

On the trade deals signed so far, Goyal said growth cannot happen in isolation, one has to secure markets, large amounts of investments, opportunities for trade, and engage with the countries that are offering the best techno-

logy. In four years, India had signed nine trade agreements, and these had been negotiated from a position of strength.

"We may have had many issues in the past, but what we are offering is an opportunity to participate in India's future, let us say [in the] next 20-50 years," he said. India opens up big opportunities at least until 2047, as it will be adding \$26 trillion to the economy. In all trade deals, the interests of farmers, fishermen and MSMEs had been protected, he added.

"Eight agreements are out in the public domain and not a single complaint from any stakeholder. With the US trade deal, India can source high-tech equipment, latest technology, lease aircraft and diversify coking coal sourcing," he said.

Cochin Port unions against removal of cabotage easing

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

The Cochin Port Joint Trade Union Forum has sought the intervention of the management following reports that the Shipping Ministry plans to withdraw the relaxation in cabotage restrictions that allowed foreign-flagged vessels to operate on Indian coastal routes.

In a letter to the Chairman of the Cochin Port Authority, CD Nandakumar, the general convener of the joint trade unions, said the relaxation in cabotage norms was secured after sustained interventions by the port management to support the Vallarpadam Container Transshipment Terminal. The policy enabled shipping lines to freely carry both coastal and EXIM cargo using Indian- or foreign-flagged vessels, helping improve connectivity.

However, the forum pointed to reports that the Centre has withdrawn three General Orders, issued in 2018, that relaxed provisions of the Merchant Shipping Act, 1958.

These orders had permitted foreign-flagged vessels to operate on India's coastal routes without a licence from the Director-

ate General of Shipping for specific cargo categories, including EXIM-laden containers meant for transshipment, empty containers for repositioning, agricultural and horticultural produce and fertilizers.

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QUICKLY.

RCom lenders analyse SC ruling on spectrum



Mumbai: Reliance Communication's (RCom) Committee of Creditors (CoC) is carrying out a detailed analysis of the recent Supreme Court ruling that bars the listing of spectrum as a company 'asset' in the case of bankruptcy. "There are multiple implications [to the court ruling]. A detailed analysis is underway," sources told *businessline*. Further, the Department of Telecom is also likely to file a review petition on the company's outstanding AGR dues. The Supreme Court recently stated that telecom service providers (TSPs) do not own spectrum, which is a finite national resource owned by the people of the country. The court held that TSPs merely hold a contractual right on spectrum and thus cannot use the same under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code for bankruptcy or liquidation. As for the prevailing telcos, the ruling limits spectrum monetisation options, not hindering bank funding prospects. **OUR BUREAU**

DoT directs Navi Mumbai airport to allow telecom firms right of way

NEW DIRECTIVES. To facilitate setting up of infrastructure, authorities told to comply with telecom regulations

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has directed the Navi Mumbai airport authorities to allow telecom companies to set up infrastructure, deeming the newly-established airport as a "public entity". "You are requested to ensure compliance with the provisions of the Telecommunications Act, 2023 and the Telecommunications (Right of Way) Rules, 2024, while processing applications for grant of RoW permissions within your premises, and to take necessary action to facilitate establishment of telecom infrastructure in accordance with the statutory framework," said DoT in its order to the Navi Mumbai International Airport Ltd. Meanwhile, telecom service providers have started tests to set up the infrastructure on the airport premises,



TRIAL RUN. Telecom service providers have started tests to set up the infrastructure on the airport premises, say sources

as per sources. Airport authorities did not comment on the development. **LICENSED TSPS** In December 2025, the Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI) wrote to DoT regarding difficulties faced by licensed telecom service providers (TSPs) in establishing telecom infrastructure at the airport. The representative body

stated that the airport authorities had denied RoW permissions to TSPs and instead required them to utilise an exclusive in-building telecom network at charges stated to be unreasonably high. The airport authorities argued that they had already procured and installed infrastructure for the mobile network after multiple talks with TSPs, with BSNL set-

ting up its own infrastructure in the area. However, Faisal Kawoosa, Chief Analyst and Founder, Techarc, told *businessline* such measures would result in service degradation since Wi-Fi connectivity cannot support the lakhs of users on the premises. "It is clarified that, in terms of the Telecommunications Act, 2023, Navi Mumbai International Airport

qualifies as a 'public entity' for the purposes of the said Act," said DoT. **SIMILAR CLASHES** Telecom bodies battle similar clashes with other public entity authorities as well like the Noida International Airport, metros such as the Mumbai Metro Rail Corporation Ltd. Such issues have persisted for at least 20 years, despite numerous attempts by Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) and DoT to resolve them. However, with land being a State subject, both TRAI and DoT have limited jurisdiction. Aside from RoW, COAI had, in the course of the discussions, asked TRAI to cap costs for in-building telecom infrastructure for public spaces. It argued that cost-based price ceilings helps avoid rent-seeking behaviour, delays in network rollout and direct consumer harm, especially where a single entity controls the access to an essential facility.

DGCA initiates exercise to simplify procedures, cut compliance burden

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The aviation safety regulator has initiated a broad exercise to simplify regulatory procedures, reduce compliance requirements and improve efficiency across the civil aviation sector. The reforms push comes at a time when aviation activity in India is expanding, including aircraft induction, aerodrome development and growth in training, maintenance and manufacturing organisations.

PROCESS REFORM Accordingly, the exercise is divided into two phases — regulatory and process reform — via a review of existing rules, circulars, guidelines and civil aviation requirements, to align procedures with internationally-harmonised standards. In this context, Director General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) Faiz Ahmed Kidwai, has written to multiple industry stakeholders, such as airlines, aerodrome operators and other regulated entities, formally launching the reform process and seeking comments and suggestions. *businessline* has reviewed a copy of this letter. According to the letter, stakeholders have been requested to examine existing procedures and submit inputs within specified timelines. Notably, the review is intended to streamline approvals, remove redundant requirements and rationalise documentation across multiple regulatory functions. Besides, the exercise includes benchmarking of existing procedures against global practices and identifying areas where processes may be simplified or delegated. Further, the regulator has proposed the constitution of



The review is intended to streamline approvals, remove redundant requirements and rationalise documentation

sector-specific committees comprising DGCA officials, industry experts and representatives of aviation organisations. As per the letter, these committees will examine current approval processes, identify bottlenecks and recommend measures for simplification. Meanwhile, timelines have been indicated for preliminary consultations, circulation of draft recommendations and finalisation after stakeholder feedback. Apart from procedural changes, the exercise covers improvements to digital systems used for regulatory transactions. The proposals under consideration include simplification of online workflows, reduction in levels of file movement, preparation of guidance material and development of user support tools.

ASSISTANCE TOOLS Additionally, measures such as mobile-based access, instructional material and automated assistance tools are being examined to facilitate interaction with applicants. The review also includes examination of regulatory compliance requirements and the scope for delegation of certain approvals to regional offices. In addition, acceptance of self-attestation or third-party certification in defined areas is among the measures being studied as broader rationalisation effort.

Ad spends on TV set for revival in 2026: WPP report

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai



Television advertising is expected to grow at 3.1 per cent in 2026 as opposed to the decline in 2025, as per WPP Media insights released on Wednesday. The trend is sustained by connected TV and addressable advertising in sectors like consumer packaged goods (CPG). WPP Media launched its latest "This Year Next Year" (TYNY) advertising forecast

in India, projecting 9.7 per cent growth with advertising revenue reaching ₹2,01,891 crore, an incremental addition of ₹17,844 crore over 2025. As part of this upward performance, TV, including

connected TV, is also expected to contribute to the growth at 3.1 per cent as compared to the global growth rate of 2.1 per cent. Last year, the TV medium was expected to decline by 1 per cent with digital platforms gaining on the back of what TV was losing. **CPG CONTEXT** However, this time, TV is expected to play a major role within the CPG context. "This is one of the reasons why we have said that TV plus CTV will grow at a 3 per

cent," said Parveen Sheik, Head of Business Intelligence, WPP Media, India. **DEFINING METRIC** This year, TV is not anticipated to witness a double digit decline in terms of volume, said Sheik. However, the defining metric will be whether CPG takes to TV, depending on variables like rural recovery and sports content in the first half of the year. Channel-wise, commerce-led advertising emerged as the fastest-growing segment

at 24.2 per cent, driven by the convergence of retail media, quick commerce and social commerce. Other digital channels comprising non-search, non-commerce will grow at 11.1 per cent, while location-based media such as OOH (out of home) and cinema expand at 8.9 per cent. Intelligence-driven formats, encompassing search (AI-powered), voice, and agentic discovery, will register 8 per cent growth. Print will register 4.4 per cent growth, supported by DAVP price in-

crease and sectoral relevance. **AD REVENUE** Overall, digital now accounts for 68.1 per cent of total ad revenue, with content-driven channels contributing 70 per cent and commerce rapidly gaining share. The report underscores India's position as a top 10 global advertising market, with the sector representing 0.5 per cent of the GDP. India continues to be one of the fastest growing markets out of the top 10 markets.



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average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour; 52-Week High/Low figures

er than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the

d) is denoted in thousands.

multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

...into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12

Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl
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262.25	Syncom Form. [1]	13.70	13.62	Utkarsh SFB	13.75	13.79
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82.70	Syrma SGS	862.80	867.70	Valiant Comm	1105.20	1069.30
1997.45	Taneia Aero [5]	274.85	270.95	Vantage Know [1]	113	113

39.39	Tata Capital I	274.85	276.55	Vantage Wires Li	47.55	47.19
892.50	Tata Capital I	355.15	355.45	Vikas Life [1]	1.62	1.61

852.50	Tata Capital L	555.15	555.45	Vikas Life [1]	1.02	1.01
794.00	Tata Tech [2]	603.90	604.55	Vikram Solar L	227.55	220.30
23.54	Tata Tech CV [2]	400.65	400.50	Vikram Eng [1]	75.57	77.74

1061.80	Tatia Global [1]	2.55	2.30	Vintage Coff.	143.15	144.90
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024.05	TBO tek [1]	1428.15	1388.85	VishalMega	120.10	120.15
17.79	TCC Concept	463.95	454.40	Vistar Amar	151.25	181.50

378.20	Techno Elec [2]	1076.25	1151.20	VL e-Govt	12.99	12.04
6.79	Tega Ind	1632.50	1627.10	Waaree Enr	3053.85	2964.10

531.60	Tejas Netwrk	334.80	336.65	Waaree Re.le [2]	887.25	894.50
156.30	Telcanor Glb	44.61	46.84	Wakefit Innova	212.95	203.60

16.95	TennecoCle	549.70	552.75	Wardwiz.Inn [1]	7.18	7.21
116.25	TGV Sracc	87.33	89.00	Waterbase	55.85	58.13

0.64	Thinkink Pic [1]	0.20	0.20	Welcure Drug [1]	0.34	0.33
0.28	Tilak Vent [1]	0.95	0.96	Welsp SplSol [6]	37.51	37.41

19.52	Timex Group [1]	298.85	300.05	Worth Inv [1]	3.54	3.71
145.80	Titan Biotech	1424.50	1294.70	WPIL [1]	401.95	404.15

143.50	Titan Biotech	1424.50	1234.70	Yatharth Hsp	691.40	694.35
474.25	Titan Int [1]	0.96	0.93	Yatra Online [1]	155.50	158.55
0.48	TMR	675.50	603.25			

603.90	Transrail Ligh [2]	590.25	589.35	Zaggle Pre [1]	260.50	256.45
59.25	Transrail Food [1]	1212.40	1214.55	Zeal [1]	15.29	15.53

58.35	Travel Food Se (1)	1213.40	1214.55	2000 (1)	13.29	13.33
179.75	Triton Corp. (1)	1.46	1.39		Group T	

413.75	Tube Invt [1]	2463.20	2470.55			
0.23	TVS Supply [1]	126.80	123.68	Axita Cot [1]	9.42	9.14

326.45	Ultracab (I) [2]	7.84	7.74	Cian Agro In	1436.40	1418.40
214.30	Unicom.eSol. [1]	118.60	116.85	Elitec.Intl [1]	72.11	75.71

333.85	Unison [1]	1.36	1.18	Kwality Walls	28.04	29.42
16.76	Univ.Photo	283.90	340.65	Midwest Gold	4845.25	4603.00

0.59	Urban Comp [1]	119.20	120.10	Murae Org [1]	0.22	0.22
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Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl	Company	Pr Cl	Cl
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0.31	Embassy Dev	64.10	63.32	Kesoram In	9.54	9.07
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9.21	Genus Pwr [1]	267.20	268.55	REL INFRA	103.85	109.04
18.29	IndoSolar	423.00	410.15	BIL COM VEN [E]	1.03	1.03

18.29	INDUSOIALE	423.00	410.15	RIECOM VEN [5]	1.03	1.02
154.65	JAIPRA [2]	3.36	3.26	Take Sol [1]	47.49	47.26

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